OM

SANATAN BHARAT FOUNDATION

Digital Platform – Deep Module Specification v2 Extended

MODULE 01 – COMPLETELY REVISED AND DEEPLY EXPANDED

SACRED TEXTS LIBRARY

The Complete Canon of Sanatan Dharma

Vedas – Upanishads – Itihasas – Puranas – Agamas – Darshanas – Smritis – Devotional Literature – Science – Regional Traditions

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Complete Deep-Dive Specification v2.0 | May 2026

Executive Summary

The sacred literature of Sanatan Dharma is the largest, most diverse, and most philosophically sophisticated body of religious writing in human history. It spans at least 5,000 years of continuous composition. It ranges from the most abstract metaphysics (the Upanishads) to the most practical technology (surgical procedures in the Sushruta Samhita), from cosmic creation narratives (the Puranas) to precise grammatical science (Panini's Ashtadhyayi). No single person can read it all in a lifetime. This module makes it navigable - giving every learner a clear map of the entire canon, deep dives into the most important texts, and tools to engage with the tradition's written heritage at every level of depth.

The Complete Canon - Architecture Overview

Category	Description	Key Texts
SHRUTI - Directly Heard	The primary revelation - the Vedas and Upanishads. Considered Apaurusheya (not of human authorship) - directly heard by the Rishis in deep meditative states. The highest authority in the tradition.	4 Vedas (Rig, Sama, Yajur, Atharva), each with Samhitas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, and Upanishads. The 108 Upanishads (10 principal ones form the core philosophical canon).
SMRITI - Remembered	The secondary literature - everything remembered and transmitted by human teachers. Subordinate in authority to Shruti but vastly larger in scope and more widely read.	The Itihasas (Mahabharata, Ramayana), the 18 Mahapuranas, the 18 Upapuranas, the Dharmashastra texts (Smritis), and the Nitishastra texts.
AGAMA - Transmitted Directly	The liturgical and ritual manuals transmitted directly from teacher to student in specific temple and worship traditions. Not subordinate to Shruti but parallel - revealed by Shiva, Vishnu, or Devi directly.	The 28 Shaiva Agamas, the Vaishnava Agamas (Pancharatra and Vaikhanasa), and the Shakta Tantras.
DARSHANA - Philosophical Vision	The six orthodox philosophical schools, each with foundational Sutras (aphoristic texts) and extensive commentary traditions.	Nyaya, Vaisheshika, Sankhya, Yoga, Purva Mimamsa, and Uttara Mimamsa (Vedanta).

Category	Description	Key Texts
VEDANGA - Limbs of the Veda	The six auxiliary sciences required to correctly understand and perform Vedic ritual.	Shiksha (phonetics), Chandas (metre), Vyakarana (grammar), Nirukta (etymology), Jyotisha (astronomy), and Kalpa (ritual procedure).
UPAVEDAS - Applied Knowledge	The four traditional sciences derived from the Vedic corpus.	Ayurveda (medicine), Dhanurveda (military science), Gandharvaveda (music and arts), and Arthashastra (statecraft and economics).
BHAKTI SAHITYA - Devotional Literature	The vast body of devotional literature in Sanskrit and all the regional languages - the living heart of the tradition for most practitioners.	The Alvars and Nayanmars (Tamil), the Varkari saints (Marathi), the Nirgunas (Hindi), the Bauls (Bengali), and parallel traditions in every Indian language.
SHASTRA SAHITYA - Scientific Texts	The tradition's contributions to mathematics, astronomy, linguistics, aesthetics, and political science.	Aryabhatiya, Brahmasphutasiddhanta, Surya Siddhanta, Arthashastra, Natyashastra, and hundreds of regional scientific texts.

Submodule 1.1 - The Vedas: The Four Primary Revelations

The Vedas are the world's oldest surviving body of philosophical and liturgical literature. They were not written down initially - they were preserved with extraordinary precision in an oral tradition stretching back at least 3,000 and possibly 5,000+ years. The system of memorisation (Pathalas - different patterns of chanting the same text) created multiple independent backups of the same text, so that any corruption would immediately become detectable. This is the world's oldest continuous quality-control system for textual transmission.

1.1.1 - The Architecture of the Vedas

Each of the four Vedas has the same four-layer structure, moving from outer ritual to inner philosophy:

Layer	Description	Key Texts	Significance
Samhita	The hymns themselves - the core collection of mantras, prayers, and sacred utterances. This is what most people mean when they say the Vedas.	Rig Veda Samhita (10,552 verses), Sama Veda Samhita (1,875 verses, mostly drawn from Rig Veda), Yajur Veda Samhita (varies by school), Atharva Veda Samhita (5,977 verses).	The most ancient layer. Some hymns (particularly in the Rig Veda) have been dated to approximately 3000-4000 BCE by astronomical calculations.
Brahmana	Prose commentaries on the Samhitas explaining the correct performance of rituals and the meaning of specific mantras in the ritual context.	Aitareya Brahmana and Shatapatha Brahmana (the longest and most important - 100 chapters, explains Vedic ritual in encyclopaedic detail). Taittiriya Brahmana.	The Shatapatha Brahmana contains the Shatapatha Satapatha version of the flood myth (similar to the Noah narrative but likely older), the earliest clear statement of the Pythagorean theorem, and sophisticated discussion of the solar year.
Aranyaka	Forest texts - transitional texts between the ritual Brahmanas and the philosophical Upanishads.	Aitareya Aranyaka, Brihadaranyaka (the largest and most important Upanishad is technically an	The Aranyakas mark the transition from outer ritual (Karma Kanda) to inner philosophical inquiry (Jnana Kanda). They contain the earliest sustained

Layer	Description	Key Texts	Significance
	Composed for use in the forest (Aranya) by forest-dwelling sages rather than household ritualists.	Aranyaka), Taittiriya Aranyaka.	philosophical speculation in any literature.
Upanishad	The philosophical summaries (Anta = end; Upanishad = the end of the Veda) - the direct investigation of the nature of ultimate reality, consciousness, and liberation.	108 Upanishads, of which 10-12 are considered principal (Mukhya Upanishads). The Prasthanatrayi (Brahmasutras, Bhagavad Gita, and the 10 principal Upanishads) forms the foundational canon of Vedanta philosophy.	Among the most profound philosophical texts in human history. Schopenhauer: I know of no study as beneficial and as elevating as the Upanishads. Hegel specifically engaged with the Upanishadic concept of Brahman in his Logic.

1.1.2 - Rig Veda: The Most Ancient Text

- THE TEXT: 10,552 verses (mantras) organised into 10 Mandalas (books). The first and last books were compiled later; books 2-7 are considered the oldest (the family books - each associated with a specific Rishi lineage). Total approximately 432,000 syllables.
- THE AUTHORS: 1,028 different Rishis are credited with composing the hymns, of whom approximately 27 are women (the Rishikas: Lopamudra, Ghoshas, Vishvavara, Apala, Gargi, Maitreyi, and others). This is the oldest body of text composed by women in any tradition.
- KEY PHILOSOPHICAL HYMNS: (1) Nasadiya Sukta (10.129) - the Creation Hymn: begins from a state before existence and non-existence, before light and darkness, before this world was born - and then asks whether even God knows how creation happened. The most sophisticated cosmological speculation in any ancient text. (2) Purusha Sukta (10.90) - the Cosmic Man: describes the universe as emerging from the sacrifice of the Primordial Being. (3) Devi Sukta (10.125) - the Goddess declares herself the source of all existence: I am the queen, the gatherer of treasures, the knower, the first of those worthy of worship. (4) Hiranyagarbha Sukta (10.121) - the Golden Womb from which the universe is born: anticipates the Big Bang by 5,000 years. (5) Ekam Sat Sukta (1.164.46) - the foundational statement of pluralistic unity: That which IS is one; the wise call it by many names.
- ASTRONOMICAL DATING: The specific astronomical observations embedded in the Rig Veda - references to star positions, solstices, and specific celestial events - have been used to date the earliest hymns to approximately 3000-4000 BCE. Scholars

including Bal Gangadhar Tilak (Arctic Home in the Vedas, 1903) and more recently Srikant Talageri have analysed the astronomical references in detail.

- SCHOOL TRADITIONS: The Rig Veda is preserved primarily in the Shakala recension. The Bashkala recension is a variant. The tradition of the Shakhalakas maintains the text through a specific system of eight different recitation patterns (Pathas) ensuring textual integrity across millennia.

1.1.3 - Sama Veda: The Musical Veda

- THE TEXT: 1,875 verses, of which 1,771 are derived directly from the Rig Veda. The Sama Veda is the musical arrangement of Rig Vedic verses for liturgical use - the world's oldest musical notation system.
- THE SIGNIFICANCE: The Sama Veda established the principles of Indian classical music. The seven swaras (Sa, Re, Ga, Ma, Pa, Dha, Ni) of Indian classical music derive from the chanting patterns (Samans) of the Sama Veda. The Gita (10.22) specifically names the Sama Veda as the Veda among the Vedas: Vedanam Sama Vedo'smi - Among the Vedas I am the Sama Veda.
- KEY TEXTS: The Chandogya Upanishad (one of the two most important Upanishads) belongs to the Sama Veda tradition. The Jaiminiya Brahmana (a Sama Veda Brahmana) contains the oldest surviving narrative prose literature in any Indo-European language.
- RECITATION SCHOOLS: The Kauthuma school (most widely practised today), the Jaiminiya school (concentrated in South India, particularly Kerala and Tamil Nadu), and the Ranayaniya school. Each school has distinct chanting traditions that preserve unique musical and linguistic information.

1.1.4 - Yajur Veda: The Ritual Veda

- THE TEXT: The Yajur Veda exists in two fundamentally different versions that represent the tradition's most important textual split. The Krishna (Black) Yajur Veda contains both the mantras AND the Brahmana prose mixed together. The Shukla (White) Yajur Veda separates them.
- KRISHNA YAJUR VEDA SCHOOLS: The Taittiriya Samhita (most widespread - the primary text of South Indian Vedic tradition), the Maitrayani Samhita, the Kathaka Samhita, and the Kapisthala Katha Samhita. The Taittiriya Upanishad and the Katha Upanishad (which contains the conversation between Nachiketa and Yama about the nature of death and consciousness) both belong to this tradition.
- SHUKLA YAJUR VEDA SCHOOLS: The Vajasaneyi Madhyandina Samhita (the most widespread Northern Indian version) and the Vajasaneyi Kanva Samhita. The Brihadaranyaka Upanishad (the largest and one of the most philosophically important Upanishads) and the Isha Upanishad (the shortest, 18 verses, considered by many to contain the essence of all Vedic teaching) both belong to this tradition.

- THE SHATAPATHA BRAHMANA: The most important of all Brahmanas, belonging to the Shukla Yajur Veda. 100 chapters, approximately 1,000,000 syllables. Contains: the story of Manu and the Great Flood, the complete ritual instructions for the Agnichayana (the most complex Vedic ritual), the first clear statement of the Pythagorean theorem in any known text, and extensive philosophical commentary that bridges the Brahmanas and Upanishads.

1.1.5 - Atharva Veda: The Practical Veda

- THE TEXT: 5,977 verses in 20 books. Named after the Rishi Atharva (and Angiras). The Atharva Veda was initially not accepted as the fourth Veda by all schools - the older tradition recognised only three Vedas (Trayi Vidya: Rig, Sama, Yajur). Its acceptance as the fourth Veda represents the tradition's integration of folk religious practices into the canonical framework.
- THE CONTENT: Unlike the other three Vedas (which focus on cosmic ritual and philosophical inquiry), the Atharva Veda addresses the practical concerns of everyday life: healing charms, spells for protection against disease and enemies, marriage rituals, agricultural prosperity, political success, and philosophical hymns. It is the oldest known manual of practical medicine.
- MEDICAL CONTENT: The Atharva Veda contains the world's oldest descriptions of specific diseases and their treatments. It names diseases including fever (Takman - likely malaria), skin diseases, intestinal diseases, and describes the use of specific plants (Kushtha, Apamarga, Pippali) as medicines. The Atharvanic medical tradition directly feeds into the Ayurvedic tradition.
- PHILOSOPHICAL HYMNS: The Prithvi Sukta (12.1) - the Hymn to the Earth - is one of the most beautiful ecological texts in any tradition: This vast Earth, on whom the trees, lords of the forest, stand firm - she is our mother and I am her son. The Skambha Suktas (Book 10) contain the tradition's most abstract philosophical inquiry into the nature of the cosmic pillar (Skambha) that supports the universe - an early form of the Brahman concept.
- UPANISHADS: The Mundaka Upanishad, the Mandukya Upanishad (the shortest - 12 verses - and by some accounts the most important of all Upanishads), and the Prashna Upanishad all belong to the Atharva Veda tradition.

Submodule 1.2 - The Upanishads: Philosophy of the Highest Order

The Upanishads are among the most remarkable philosophical achievements in human history. Composed over a period of approximately 1,500 years (800 BCE - 700 CE), they represent a sustained and progressive inquiry into the nature of consciousness, reality, and liberation. The word itself means to sit near - the sitting of a student at the feet of a teacher to receive the direct transmission of understanding. The Upanishads are not theology (belief about God) but phenomenology (direct investigation of the nature of experience).

1.2.1 - The Ten Principal (Mukhya) Upanishads

Adi Shankaracharya (8th century CE) wrote commentaries on ten Upanishads, establishing them as the primary canon. Ramanuja added the Kausitaki and Swetasvatara. All 108 Upanishads are considered valid Shruti; the following are the most philosophically central:

Upanishad	Description	Key Content	Significance
Brihadaranyaka	The largest (Brihad = large) and oldest datable Upanishad. Belongs to the Shukla Yajur Veda. 6 chapters, approximately 60,000 words.	The dialogue between Yajnavalkya and Gargi (the philosopher-queen who almost defeats the greatest thinker of her age in public debate). Yajnavalkya's Neti Neti (not this, not this) method of defining Brahman by negation. The teaching of the five sheaths (Panchakosha) that cover the Atman. The teaching that Brahman is Satyam, Jnanam, Anantam (Truth, Knowledge, Infinity).	The most cited Upanishad by both Shankaracharya and Ramanuja. Contains some of the most sophisticated philosophical dialogues in any language.
Chandogya	The second largest. Belongs to the Sama Veda tradition. 8 chapters.	The Uddalaka-Shvetaketu dialogues (father teaching son) containing the great statement Tat tvam asi - That art thou. The teaching that Brahman is Annam (food), Prana (life-breath), Manas (mind), Vijnana (understanding), and Ananda (bliss) - the Panchakosha from a different angle. The story of	Tat tvam asi (Chandogya 6.8.7) is one of the four Mahavakyas (Great Sayings) of the Upanishadic tradition. The basis for Advaita Vedanta's teaching of identity between Atman and Brahman.

Upanishad	Description	Key Content	Significance
		Satyakama (who is accepted as a student even though he does not know his father's name - the tradition's most explicit anti-caste statement in the form of a narrative).	
Aitareya	Short (3 chapters). Belongs to the Rig Veda tradition. Contains some of the tradition's most ancient philosophical content.	The creation account (unique to this Upanishad - Brahman creates the universe from his own desire, and then enters into every created being). The identification of Prajnanam (pure consciousness) as Brahman - the second Mahavakya: Prajnanam Brahma (Aitareya 3.3).	One of the four Mahavakyas. Short and dense - often used as an introduction to Upanishadic study.
Taittiriya	3 chapters. Belongs to the Krishna Yajur Veda tradition. Widely taught in South Indian Vedic education.	The teaching of the Panchakosha (five sheaths surrounding the Atman): Annamaya (food-body), Pranamaya (breath-body), Manomaya (mind-body), Vijnanamaya (intellect-body), and Anandamaya (bliss-body). The declaration that Brahman is Satyam Jnanam Anantam (Truth, Consciousness, Infinity).	The Panchakosha model is the basis for the tradition's understanding of the human being as a multi-layered system - directly applied in Yoga, Ayurveda, and the psychological tradition.
Mandukya	The shortest (12 verses) and by many accounts the most important. Belongs to the Atharva Veda tradition.	The analysis of consciousness into four states: Jagrat (waking), Svapna (dreaming), Sushupti (deep sleep), and Turiya (the fourth - the witnessing consciousness that underlies and pervades all three states). The analysis of the mantra AUM into its four components corresponding to the four states of consciousness. The teaching that Turiya (pure consciousness) is the real nature of every being.	Gaudapada (Shankaracharya's guru's guru) wrote the Mandukya Karika - a commentary that establishes the philosophical foundations of Advaita Vedanta. Shankaracharya said this single Upanishad is sufficient for liberation. The analysis of the four states of consciousness anticipates modern neurological research

Upanishad	Description	Key Content	Significance
			on sleep, dreaming, and waking states.
Kena	4 sections. Belongs to the Sama Veda tradition. Gets its name from the first word: Kena (By whom?).	The question: by whom does the mind think? By whose power does the breath go forth? The eye see? The teaching that Brahman is not what the eye sees but what makes seeing possible; not what the mind thinks but what makes thinking possible. The story of Indra, Agni, and Vayu attempting to touch a Yaksha (Brahman in disguise) - and their failure.	Addresses the Hard Problem of Consciousness before there was a name for it. The question of who or what makes perception possible is the most fundamental question in philosophy of mind.
Katha	2 chapters. Belongs to the Krishna Yajur Veda tradition.	The conversation between the boy Nachiketa and Yama (the Lord of Death). Nachiketa asks: what happens after a man dies? Yama first tries to deflect with worldly gifts; when Nachiketa insists, Yama delivers the complete teaching of the Atman. The chariot metaphor (the body is the chariot, the Atman is the passenger, the intellect is the charioteer, the senses are the horses, the mind is the reins).	The chariot metaphor of the Katha Upanishad directly inspires the Bhagavad Gita's opening scene. Cited by Max Muller as one of the most beautiful philosophical texts in any language. The Nachiketa-Yama dialogue is the tradition's definitive treatment of death and consciousness.
Isha	18 verses. The shortest Upanishad to be given full canonical status. Belongs to the Shukla Yajur Veda tradition (its 40th chapter).	The opening verse: Everything in this moving world is pervaded by God. Enjoy by renouncing; covet not what belongs to others. The teaching of the integration of knowledge and action (Jnana and Karma) - the renunciant and the householder both realise the divine through their appropriate path.	Mahatma Gandhi said that if all other scriptures were destroyed and only this Upanishad survived, he would have everything he needed. The integration of world-affirmation and world-renunciation in 18 verses.
Mundaka	3 chapters. Belongs to the Atharva Veda tradition.	The distinction between Para Vidya (the higher knowledge, knowledge of Brahman) and Apara Vidya (the lower knowledge - all other sciences including the Vedas as ritual).	The basis for the tradition's epistemological hierarchy - knowledge of the Self is the highest knowledge

Upanishad	Description	Key Content	Significance
		The bow-and-arrow metaphor: the Atman is the arrow, Brahman is the target, the bow is AUM, the string is the mind. The teaching: one must make oneself the arrow, sharpen oneself through meditation, and release into Brahman.	from which all other knowledge is derived. Contains the famous statement: Satyam eva jayate (Truth alone triumphs) - later adopted as India's national motto.
Prashna	6 chapters. Belongs to the Atharva Veda tradition. A dialogue format where six students ask questions and the teacher Pippalada answers each.	The six questions: (1) What is the origin of all created beings? (2) How many devas support a creature? (3) How does Prana relate to the sense organs? (4) Which functions continue in sleep? (5) What is the nature of AUM? (6) Who is the Purusha of 16 aspects (16 Kalas)?	The most systematic of the Upanishads - each question and answer forms a complete philosophical analysis.

1.2.2 - Additional Important Upanishads

Upanishad	Tradition	Key Content
Swetasvatara	Belongs to the Krishna Yajur Veda tradition. Particularly important for the Shaiva tradition.	The most theistic of the principal Upanishads - explicitly names Rudra (Shiva) as the supreme personal deity. Contains the famous Mrityunjaya Mantra and the teaching that God is both the material cause and the efficient cause of the universe. A bridge between the impersonal Brahman of the early Upanishads

Upanishad	Tradition	Key Content
		and the personal God of the theistic traditions.
Maitri / Maitrayani	Belongs to the Krishna Yajur Veda tradition.	Contains the most explicit early account of the three Gunas (Sattva, Rajas, Tamas) as qualities of Prakriti. Also contains one of the earliest references to Yoga as a systematic practice. A transitional text between the early Upanishads and the Sankhya-Yoga tradition.
Kaushitaki	Belongs to the Rig Veda tradition.	The teaching of Prana (life-breath) as Brahman. The story of Pratardana visiting Indra. Notable for its proto-Samkhya analysis of consciousness.
Mahanarayana	Belongs to the Krishna Yajur Veda tradition. Particularly important in South Indian Vedic liturgy.	Contains important liturgical hymns including the Gayatri Mantra elaboration, the Narayana Sukta, the Purusha Sukta, and the Medha Sukta. Widely recited in South Indian temples.
Yoga Upanishads (20 texts)	A collection of 20 Upanishads specifically addressing Yoga philosophy and practice.	The Yoga Shikha, Yoga Tattva, Shandilya, Trishikhi-Brahmana, and others. These texts elaborate the Yoga Sutras tradition

Upanishad	Tradition	Key Content
		with additional detail on pranayama, mudras, and states of consciousness.
Sannyasa Upanishads (17 texts)	A collection specifically addressing the life of the renunciant.	The Jabala Upanishad (the foundational text authorising the renunciant order), the Narada Parivrajaka, the Ashrama, and others. These texts define the Sannyasa Ashrama in philosophical and practical detail.
Vaishnava Upanishads	A collection of Upanishads within the Vaishnava devotional tradition.	The Narayana, Nrisimha Tapaniya, Rama Tapaniya, Gopala Tapaniya (the most important Vaishnava Upanishad, foundational to Gaudiya Vaishnavism), and others.
Shaiva Upanishads	A collection within the Shaiva tradition.	The Atharva Shiras (addressing Rudra as the supreme deity), the Dakshinamurti Upanishad, the Kalagnirudra, and others.

Submodule 1.3 - The Brahmasutras and the Prasthanatrayi

The Brahmasutras (also called the Vedanta Sutras or Shariraka Mimamsa Sutras) are the systematisation of Upanishadic philosophy into 555 aphoristic statements. Composed by Badarayana Vyasa (generally dated to approximately 400 BCE - 200 CE), they synthesise the diverse and sometimes apparently contradictory teachings of the Upanishads into a coherent philosophical system. The Brahmasutras are the foundational text of Vedanta philosophy - every major Vedanta school has produced a commentary on them.

1.3.1 - The Brahmasutras

- THE TEXT: 555 sutras (aphoristic statements) organised into 4 chapters (Adhyayas), each divided into 4 sections (Padas). The sutras are so terse (most are 2-4 words) that they are essentially incomprehensible without a commentary. This is deliberate - the text was designed to be studied with a qualified teacher who provides the interpretive tradition.
- CHAPTER 1 (SAMANVAYA - Consistency): Establishes that all the diverse Upanishadic statements are consistent and refer to Brahman (ultimate reality) as the subject of inquiry.
- CHAPTER 2 (AVIRODHA - Non-contradiction): Refutes objections from rival philosophical schools (Sankhya, Vaisheshika, Buddhism, Jainism) and demonstrates that the Upanishadic teaching is internally consistent.
- CHAPTER 3 (SADHANA - Means): Addresses the means of attaining Brahman - the role of knowledge (Jnana), meditation (Upasana), and practice (Sadhana) in the path to liberation.
- CHAPTER 4 (PHALA - Fruit): Describes the state of liberation and what happens after the realised sage's death.
- THE THREE MAJOR COMMENTARIES: (1) Shankaracharya's Shariraka Bhashya - the Advaita interpretation: Brahman is the sole reality; Jiva and Brahman are identical; the apparent difference is due to Maya. (2) Ramanuja's Sri Bhashya - the Vishishtadvaita interpretation: Brahman is the personal God who contains all souls and matter within himself; Jiva and Brahman are related as part to whole, not identical. (3) Madhva's Anuvyakhyana - the Dvaita interpretation: Brahman (Vishnu) and Jiva are eternally and fundamentally distinct.

1.3.2 - The Bhagavad Gita: Scripture for Humanity

- THE TEXT: 700 verses in 18 chapters, embedded in the Bhishma Parva of the Mahabharata (Chapters 23-40 of the Bhishma Parva). The most widely read text of the tradition. Translated into more languages (over 250) than any other Indian text.
- THE EIGHTEEN CHAPTERS: Ch.1 (Arjuna Vishada Yoga - the yoga of despondency), Ch.2 (Sankhya Yoga - the yoga of the eternal), Ch.3 (Karma Yoga - the yoga of action), Ch.4 (Jnana Karma Sannyas Yoga - the yoga of wisdom-action-renunciation), Ch.5 (Karma Sannyas Yoga - the yoga of renunciation of action), Ch.6 (Atma Samyam Yoga - the yoga of self-restraint), Ch.7 (Jnana Vijnana Yoga - the yoga of knowledge and wisdom), Ch.8 (Akshara Brahma Yoga - the yoga of the imperishable Brahman), Ch.9 (Raja Vidya Raja Guhya Yoga - the yoga of royal knowledge and the royal secret), Ch.10 (Vibhuti Yoga - the yoga of divine manifestations), Ch.11 (Vishvarupa Darshana Yoga - the yoga of the cosmic form), Ch.12 (Bhakti Yoga - the yoga of devotion), Ch.13 (Kshetra Kshetrajna Vibhaga Yoga - the yoga of the field and the knower of the field), Ch.14 (Gunatraya Vibhaga Yoga - the yoga of the three Gunas), Ch.15 (Purushottama Yoga - the yoga of the supreme person), Ch.16 (Daivasura Sampad Vibhaga Yoga - the yoga of divine and demoniac natures), Ch.17 (Shraddhatraya Vibhaga Yoga - the yoga of the threefold faith), Ch.18 (Moksha Sannyas Yoga - the yoga of liberation and renunciation).
- THE FIVE MAJOR COMMENTARIES: (1) Shankaracharya's Gita Bhashya - the Jnana emphasis: the Gita teaches liberation through knowledge of the non-dual Atman; Karma Yoga is preparation, not the final path. (2) Ramanuja's Gita Bhashya - the Bhakti emphasis: the Gita teaches that total surrender to the personal God (Prapatti) is the highest path. (3) Madhva's Gita Bhashya - the Dvaita emphasis: the Gita teaches eternal devotion to Vishnu who is ontologically distinct from all souls. (4) Abhinavagupta's Gitartha Samgraha - the Kashmir Shaivite reading. (5) Bal Gangadhar Tilak's Gita Rahasya (1915) - the Karma Yoga emphasis: the Gita's central teaching is engaged action without attachment to outcomes.
- THE EIGHTEEN MAJOR LATER COMMENTARIES: Jnaneshwari (Jnanadeva, 13th century Marathi - the most important regional language commentary), Vivekachudamani context, Vivekananda's lectures on the Gita, Aurobindo's Essays on the Gita, Gandhi's Anasaktiyoga, Swami Chinmayananda's commentary, Swami Prabhupada's Bhagavad Gita As It Is (ISKCON standard), S. Radhakrishnan's philosophical commentary.

Submodule 1.4 - The Itihasas: The Great Epics

The Itihasas (literally, It was thus - the historical records) are the two great epics of the tradition: the Mahabharata and the Ramayana. Together they are the longest works of literature in human history. More importantly, they are the tradition's primary vehicles for transmitting dharmic values to the general population - the philosophical principles of the Vedas and Upanishads are embedded in narratives of extraordinary human complexity.

1.4.1 - The Mahabharata

- SCALE: The Mahabharata is the longest poem ever composed. In its critical edition (the definitive academic edition published by the Bhandarkar Oriental Research Institute, Pune, 1919-1966), it contains approximately 74,000 verses. The commonly cited figure of 100,000 verses (Sata Sahasri Samhita) includes later interpolations. For comparison: the Mahabharata is 10 times longer than the Iliad and Odyssey combined.
- THE CORE NARRATIVE: The Kuru dynasty's conflict between the five Pandava brothers (Yudhishthira, Bhima, Arjuna, Nakula, Sahadeva) and their hundred Kaurava cousins (led by Duryodhana) over the kingdom of Hastinapura. The 18-day Kurukshetra war. The aftermath. The ascent of the Pandavas to heaven. The text says of itself: Yad ihasti tad anyatra; yan nehasti na tat kvachit - Whatever is here about dharma, about artha, about kama, about moksha may be found elsewhere; what is not here is nowhere.
- THE 18 PARVAS (BOOKS): Adi Parva (Origins), Sabha Parva (The Assembly Hall), Vana Parva (The Forest), Virata Parva (The Year of Disguise), Udyoga Parva (Preparations for War), Bhishma Parva (contains the Bhagavad Gita), Drona Parva, Karna Parva, Shalya Parva, Sauptika Parva (Night Massacre), Stri Parva (Women), Shanti Parva (Peace - the longest single Parva, containing extensive teaching on dharma and philosophy), Anushasana Parva (Instructions), Ashvamedhika Parva (Horse Sacrifice), Ashramavasika Parva (Forest Hermitage), Mausala Parva (Fall of the Yadavas), Mahaprasthanika Parva (The Final Journey), Svargarohana Parva (Ascent to Heaven). Plus the Harivamsa as the Khila (appendix) - dedicated entirely to Krishna's biography.
- KEY PHILOSOPHICAL SECTIONS BEYOND THE GITA: The Shanti Parva (Books 12-13) contains the Moksha Dharma section - a vast encyclopaedia of philosophical teachings from multiple schools, presented through dialogues between Bhishma (lying on his bed of arrows) and Yudhishthira. The Anugita (a second dialogue between Krishna and Arjuna after the war) provides additional Gita-like teaching. The Vidura Niti (from the Sabha Parva) is the tradition's most important text on political and personal ethics. The Yaksha Prashna (Vana Parva) contains the dialogue between Yudhishthira and the divine Yaksha who poses 125 philosophical questions.

- VERSIONS AND COMMENTARIES: The critical edition (Bhandarkar Oriental Research Institute). The commentary by Nilakantha Chaturdhara (17th century) - the standard traditional commentary. Kisari Mohan Ganguli's complete English translation (1883-1896, 12 volumes). C. Rajagopalachari's condensed version (widely read). The Jaya (the kernel of the text, 8,800 verses) was the original composition; it grew to the Bharata (24,000 verses) and then to the Mahabharata (100,000 verses) through accretion over centuries.

1.4.2 - The Valmiki Ramayana

- SCALE: 24,000 verses (shloka) in 7 Kandas (books). Attributed to the sage Valmiki, who is called the Adi Kavi (the first poet) - the Ramayana is considered the first kavya (literary poem) in the Sanskrit tradition.
- THE 7 KANDAS: Bala Kanda (Youth - Rama's birth, education, and marriage to Sita), Ayodhya Kanda (Ayodhya - Rama's exile), Aranya Kanda (Forest - the abduction of Sita), Kishkindha Kanda (Kishkindha - alliance with Sugriva and Hanuman), Sundara Kanda (Beautiful - Hanuman's journey to Lanka, most widely recited independently), Yuddha Kanda (War - the battle and Rama's victory), Uttara Kanda (The Aftermath - Sita's second exile, Rama's reign, and ascension). Note: many scholars consider the Uttara Kanda a later addition.
- THE FIVE MAJOR VERSIONS: (1) Valmiki Ramayana (Sanskrit, 24,000 verses, considered the original). (2) Ramcharitmanas (Tulsidas, 16th century Awadhi Hindi, 10,902 verses) - the most widely known version in North India; Tulsidas's rendering has shaped popular Hinduism more profoundly than any other single text. (3) Kamba Ramayanam (Kamban, Tamil, 12th century, 10,000+ verses) - the defining cultural text of Tamil civilisation. (4) Adhyatma Ramayana (Sanskrit, embedded in the Brahmanda Purana) - the spiritual/allegorical reading where Rama and Sita are cosmic principles. (5) Ranganatha Ramayana (Gona Buddha Reddy, Telugu, 12th century). Plus hundreds of regional adaptations.
- THEOLOGICAL SIGNIFICANCE: The Ramayana is the tradition's primary text of Maryada Dharma - the dharma of right conduct and boundaries. Rama as Maryada Purushottam (the ideal of one who upholds all boundaries) and Hanuman as the ideal of selfless devoted service have been the tradition's most enduring models of character. The Sundara Kanda (Hanuman's journey to Lanka) is recited independently as an auspicious text - its 2,885 verses are memorised by millions and chanted for protection and blessings.

1.4.3 - Other Itihasa Texts

Text	Scale	Key Content
Harivamsa	An appendix (Khila) to the Mahabharata. 16,374 verses in 3 sections (Harivamsa Parva, Vishnu Parva, Bhavishya Parva).	The definitive biography of Krishna, from his divine origin through his birth, childhood (Bal Krishna lilas), youth (Vrindavana period), and adult life (Mathura, Dwaraka periods). The foundational text for the Bhagavata tradition's understanding of Krishna.
Yoga Vasishtha	Also known as the Maha Ramayana. A massive philosophical text (32,000 verses in the shorter version, 64,000 in the longer) presented as a dialogue between the sage Vasishtha and the young Rama before the events of the Valmiki Ramayana.	One of the tradition's most extraordinary philosophical texts - uses extended narratives (embedded stories within stories within stories) to explore the nature of consciousness, the origin of the world, and the path to liberation. The Advaita Vedanta tradition considers it one of its most important texts. Swami Vivekananda said it was one of the greatest books ever written.
Devi Bhagavata	Often classified with the Puranas but considered by the Shakta tradition as an Itihasa. 18,000 verses.	The primary sacred text of the Shakta tradition - presents the Devi (Goddess) as the supreme personal deity who creates, preserves, and dissolves the

Text	Scale	Key Content
		universe. Contains the Devi Gita (analogous to the Bhagavad Gita) where the Goddess herself teaches Himalaya.

Submodule 1.5 - The Puranas: The Encyclopaedia of the Tradition

The Puranas are the tradition's encyclopaedia - vast storehouses of cosmology, genealogy, geography, history, mythology, theology, philosophy, ritual, ethics, and medicine. Composed over approximately 1,500 years (300-1,500 CE), the 18 Mahapuranas together contain approximately 400,000 verses. They were specifically designed to make the Vedic tradition accessible to all people - women, Shudras, and all those who could not access Sanskrit Vedic education directly.

1.5.1 - The 18 Mahapuranas: Complete Reference

Purana	Scale and Tradition	Key Content	Significance
Bhagavata Purana (Shrimad Bhagavatam)	12 books, 18,000 verses. The most beloved and widely read of all the Puranas. Dedicated to Vishnu/Krishna. Composed in exquisitely beautiful Sanskrit.	The 10th Skandha (book) containing Krishna's complete life story is the most widely read section. Rasa Lila. Uddhava Gita (Krishna's final teaching to Uddhava - sometimes called the Uddhava Gita, 11th Skandha). The Bhagavata's philosophy of Bhakti (devotion as the highest path). Shuka narrating to Parikshit. The concept of the 10 incarnations (Dashavatara).	Considered the Phalashruti (the fruit) of the Vedic tree. Ramakrishna Paramahamsa called it the ripe fruit of the Veda. The foundational text for the Bhakti movement and for Gaudiya Vaishnavism (ISKCON tradition).
Vishnu Purana	6 books, 23,000 verses. The earliest datable Purana (approximately 1st-4th century CE).	The creation of the universe (Srishti), dissolution (Pralaya), genealogy of the gods and sages, the Manvantaras (cosmic ages). The story of Prahlada and Narasimha. The complete biography of Krishna in the 5th book (predating the Bhagavata Purana's treatment).	H.H. Wilson called it the best example of what a Purana should be. The most systematic theological exposition of Vaishnavism.

Purana	Scale and Tradition	Key Content	Significance
Shiva Purana	7 Samhitas, 24,000 verses. The primary scriptural authority for the Shaiva tradition.	The nature of Shiva as supreme deity (Parashiva), the origin of the 12 Jyotirlingas (sacred Shiva shrines), the detailed narrative of Sati and Parvati (the divine feminine as Shiva's consort), the significance of specific Shaiva practices (Rudrabhishek, wearing Vibhuti/Rudraksha).	The foundational text for the understanding of Shiva's nature and iconography. Contains the most detailed treatment of Shiva's 1,008 names (Shiva Sahasranama).
Devi Bhagavata Purana	12 Skandhas, 18,000 verses. The Shakta tradition's most important Purana.	The Devi as supreme reality - the source of Brahma, Vishnu, and Shiva. The Devi Gita (Book 7, chapters 31-40). The story of the nine Durgas (Navadurga). The 108 Shakti Pithas and their origins. The philosophy of Shakti as the universal energy underlying all existence.	The theological foundation of Shakta philosophy. Contains the most comprehensive treatment of the Devi as both transcendent reality and immanent power.
Linga Purana	11,000 verses. Focused on Shiva in his Linga (phallus/cosmic pillar) form.	The origin of the Shiva Linga as a cosmic pillar of light (Jyotirlinga). The theology of the Linga as a symbol of the infinite (not a literal phallus). The story of Brahma and Vishnu failing to find the top and bottom of the infinite pillar of light.	Essential for understanding the philosophical meaning of Shiva Linga worship - one of the most misunderstood practices in the tradition.
Skanda Purana	The largest of all the Puranas - 81,000 verses. Dedicated to Skanda (Kartikeya/Murugan).	The Mahatmyas (glorifications) of sacred sites (Tirthas) throughout India - the most comprehensive guide to the tradition's sacred geography. The Kashi Khand (glorification of Varanasi), the Kedara Khand, the Prabhasa Khand, and many others.	Essential for understanding the tradition's sacred geography and pilgrimage traditions. Contains detailed descriptions of hundreds of temples and shrines.

Purana	Scale and Tradition	Key Content	Significance
Markandeya Purana	9,000 verses. One of the oldest Puranas. Named after the sage Markandeya.	Contains the Devi Mahatmyam (Durga Saptashati or Chandi Path) - 700 verses describing the Devi's victories over the demons Madhu-Kaitabha, Mahishasura, and Shumbha-Nishumbha. The most widely recited text in the Shakta tradition.	The Devi Mahatmyam is recited during Navratri by millions every year. It is the world's first literary work that describes the divine as fundamentally feminine and as the saviour of the universe.
Agni Purana	15,400 verses. The most encyclopaedic of the Puranas.	Covers: Cosmology, Temple architecture (Vastu Shastra), Iconography (Pratima Lakshanam), Poetics (Sahitya Darpana), Ayurveda, Military science, Law (Dharmashastra), Grammar, and Philosophy. Essentially an encyclopaedia of classical Indian knowledge.	The best single-volume introduction to the breadth of classical Indian knowledge. Contains important technical sections not found in other Puranas.
Bhavishya Purana	14,500 verses. Dedicated primarily to the sun god Surya.	Predictions (Bhavishya = future) about historical events, solar worship traditions, the significance of specific festivals, and some of the most important descriptions of Vrata (ritual vows) and their significance.	Contains the most detailed descriptions of the major Hindu festivals and their observance protocols. Its historical sections are controversial among scholars.
Brahmanda Purana	12,000 verses. Contains the Adhyatma Ramayana as its central section.	The Adhyatma Ramayana (the spiritual reading of the Ramayana where Rama and Sita represent cosmic principles). The Lalita Sahasranama (the thousand names of the Goddess Lalita) - one of the most important texts of the Sri Vidya tradition.	The Lalita Sahasranama is recited daily by millions of Sri Vidya practitioners. Its philosophical content is among the most sophisticated in the Shakta tradition.
Brahma Vaivarta Purana	18,000 verses. Dedicated to Krishna and Radha.	The theology of Radha as the supreme Shakti - higher even than Brahma,	The primary scriptural source for the Radha theology

Purana	Scale and Tradition	Key Content	Significance
		Vishnu, and Shiva. Krishna and Radha as the supreme divine couple. The most detailed treatment of the Radha-Krishna theology foundational to Gaudiya Vaishnavism.	that later develops fully in the Gaudiya tradition through Chaitanya Mahaprabhu and the Vrindavana Goswamis.
Padma Purana	55,000 verses. One of the largest Puranas. Dedicated to Vishnu.	Divided into 5 sections (Srishti, Bhumi, Swarga, Patala, Uttara Khanda). Contains the Shiva Gita (Krishna teaches Shiva in the Bhumi Khanda). The Brahma Gita. Important devotional narratives and pilgrimage descriptions.	Contains the Shiva Gita - a text in which the theological synthesis between Shaivism and Vaishnavism is explicitly addressed.
Kurma Purana	17,000 verses. Named after the Kurma (Tortoise) Avatar of Vishnu.	The Kurma Gita - Vishnu teaching a philosophical discourse in his Kurma form. The Ishvara Gita (Shiva's teaching). Detailed descriptions of the Kurukshetra pilgrimage. The Vyas Gita.	One of the few Puranas that includes major philosophical discourses (Gitas) as distinct from narrative sections.
Matsya Purana	14,000 verses. Named after the Matsya (Fish) Avatar.	Temple construction (Prasada Lakshanam). Sculpture and iconography (Pratima Lakshanam). The Manu-Matsya narrative (the flood story). Pilgrimage sites. Contains important architectural specifications.	The most technically detailed treatment of temple architecture and iconography in any Purana.
Garuda Purana	19,000 verses. Named after Garuda, Vishnu's eagle vehicle.	The Preta Kanda (section on the dead) - the most detailed description in any text of the journey of the soul after death, the experiences in various after-death realms, and the significance of specific death rites (Shraddha, Antyesti). Also contains important sections on	The primary text recited at death and during mourning periods. Its detailed account of the after-death journey has shaped Hindu understanding of death and the afterlife more than any other text.

Purana	Scale and Tradition	Key Content	Significance
		Ayurveda, astrology, and gemology.	
Vayu Purana	24,000 verses. Dedicated to Vayu (the wind god).	Cosmology and chronology (the most systematic treatment of the Yugas and Kalpas in any Purana). Genealogy of the lunar and solar dynasties. The creation of the Vedas. Geography of the cosmic realms.	Contains the most systematic cosmological and chronological framework in the Puranic tradition.
Vamana Purana	10,000 verses. Named after the Vamana (Dwarf) Avatar.	The complete narrative of the Vamana-Bali episode. The theology of the three worlds. Shaivite and Vaishnavite content mixed - unusual among the Puranas.	One of the shorter Puranas, notable for its synthesis of Shaiva and Vaishnava elements.
Narada Purana	25,000 verses. Presented as the teaching of the sage Narada.	The Narada Bhakti Sutras (embedded within). Extensive treatment of all the major pilgrimage sites. The theology of Bhakti. Instructions for the performance of all the major festivals.	Contains some of the most important early Bhakti philosophy, including passages that directly anticipate the Narada Bhakti Sutras tradition.
Brahma Purana	10,000 verses. The first in the traditional list of 18 Mahapuranas (though not necessarily the oldest).	Geography and significance of Odisha (Orissa) - particularly Puri and the Jagannath tradition. The Ratha Yatra (chariot festival). Descriptions of sacred sites in Odisha.	The foundational text for the Jagannath tradition at Puri - one of the four Dhams (sacred seats) established by Shankaracharya.

Submodule 1.6 - The Agamas and Tantras: The Living Ritual Tradition

The Agamas and Tantras are the tradition's liturgical sciences - the detailed manuals for temple worship, personal practice, and the activation of sacred space. They are not subordinate to the Vedas but run parallel to them: they claim independent revelation directly from Shiva, Vishnu, or the Goddess. The vast majority of actual temple worship in India today is conducted according to Agamic rather than Vedic protocols.

1.6.1 - The Shaiva Agamas

- THE CANON: The tradition recognises 28 Shaiva Agamas (sometimes called the 28 Mula Agamas - root Agamas), each with 4 sections (Padas): Vidya Pada (knowledge), Yoga Pada (practice), Kriya Pada (ritual), and Charya Pada (conduct). Each Mula Agama also has subsidiary texts (Upagamas) - the tradition recognises 207 Shaiva Upagamas.
- THE MOST IMPORTANT SHAIVA AGAMAS: (1) Kamika Agama - the most widely used in South Indian temples; the standard reference for temple construction and worship protocols in the Shaiva tradition. (2) Karana Agama - important for temple architecture (Vastu). (3) Suprabhedha Agama - the primary reference for the Siddhanta tradition. (4) Ajita Agama - important for the South Indian Shaiva Siddhanta tradition.
- THE SHAIVA SIDDHANTA TRADITION: The Shaiva Siddhanta (the established conclusion of Shaivism) is the oldest surviving living theological system in the world - its unbroken institutional tradition goes back at least 1,500 years. It is based on the 28 Shaiva Agamas and is the doctrinal basis for most South Indian temple worship. The Shaiva Siddhanta philosophy: Pati (God = Shiva), Pashu (soul = the individual), Pasha (bonds = Anava Mala, Karma Mala, Maya Mala). Liberation is the removal of the three bonds through Shiva's grace.
- THE KASHMIR SHAIVISM TRADITION: A separate philosophical tradition (non-dualistic unlike Shaiva Siddhanta's qualified dualism), based on texts including the Shiva Sutras (revealed to Vasugupta, 9th century CE), the Spanda Karikas, the Pratyabhijna Hridayam (Kshemaraja's introduction to the recognition philosophy), and the vast works of Abhinavagupta (c. 950-1020 CE). Abhinavagupta's Tantraloka (37 chapters, the most comprehensive work in Tantra philosophy) and Tantrasara are the summit of Kashmir Shaivism.

1.6.2 - The Vaishnava Agamas

- THE PANCHARATRA AGAMAS: The primary liturgical tradition for most Vaishnava temples in India. The Pancharatra tradition recognises 108 Pancharatra Samhitas (though many have been lost). The most important surviving ones: Ahirbudhnya Samhita (the most philosophically sophisticated), Sattvata Samhita (one of the oldest), Jayakhya Samhita, Paushkara Samhita, Lakshmitantra (the Shakti-Vaishnava synthesis), and Isvara Samhita. The Pancharatra tradition is the ritual basis for the Vaikhanasa tradition of South Indian Vishnu temples.
- THE VAIKHANASA TRADITION: An ancient tradition claiming Vedic origins (they consider themselves Vedic, not Agamic). The Vaikhanasa Grihyasutras and the Vaikhanasa Shrauta Sutras are their foundational texts. The Vaikhanasa tradition is particularly important at the Venkateswara temple at Tirumala (the most visited pilgrimage site in the world), where their specific ritual protocols have been followed continuously for over 1,000 years.

1.6.3 - The Shakta Tantras

- THE TANTRA TRADITION: The word Tantra means to weave or to expand. Tantra texts are practise manuals - they address the activation of Shakti (divine energy) in the human body and in ritual space. The Tantra tradition is pan-sectarian: there are Shaiva Tantras, Vaishnava Tantras, and Shakta Tantras.
- THE 64 TANTRAS: The Shakta tradition recognises 64 primary Tantras, divided into three streams: (1) Dakshina Marga (right-hand path) - using symbolic substitutes for the five Makaras (Madya, Mamsa, Matsya, Mudra, Maithuna), emphasising internal yoga rather than external ritual. (2) Vama Marga (left-hand path) - literal use of the five Makaras in specific ritual contexts. (3) Mishra Marga (mixed path). The majority of practising Tantrikas follow the Dakshina Marga.
- THE SRI VIDYA TRADITION: The highest and most widely practised Shakta Tantra tradition. The central practice is the worship of Sri Lalita Tripura Sundari (the supreme Goddess in her most beautiful and benevolent aspect) through the Sri Yantra (the most complex geometric yantra in the tradition) and the Panchadashi Mantra (15 syllables, the most powerful mantra in the Sri Vidya tradition). Key texts: the Soundarya Lahari (Adi Shankaracharya's devotional poem describing the Goddess - 100 verses of extraordinary beauty and philosophical depth), the Parashurama Kalpasutra, the Nityashodashikarnava, and the Yogini Hridaya.
- THE SHAKTA TANTRAS SPECIFICALLY: The Kularnava Tantra (one of the most important surviving Tantric texts - 17 chapters on the complete Kaula system), the Mahanirvana Tantra (particularly important for Bengali Shakta tradition), the Todala Tantra, the Devi Gita (embedded in the Devi Bhagavata Purana, Chapter 7).

Submodule 1.7 - The Six Darshanas: The Philosophical Schools

The six orthodox philosophical schools (Shad Darshana - six visions of reality) represent the tradition's most systematic philosophical inquiry. They are called orthodox (Astika) because they all accept the authority of the Vedas - distinguishing them from the heterodox schools (Nastika: Buddhism, Jainism, Charvaka). Each school has a foundational sutra text and a vast commentary tradition spanning over two millennia.

School	Primary Texts	Core Teachings	Significance
Nyaya	Foundational text: Nyaya Sutras of Gautama (c. 2nd century BCE). Major commentaries: Nyaya Bhashya (Vatsyayana, 5th century), Nyaya Vartika (Uddyotakara, 7th century), Nyaya Tatparya Tika (Vacaspati Mishra, 9th century), Tatparyaparisuddhi (Udayana, 11th century).	The Nyaya school is primarily a school of epistemology and logic. Its four Pramanas (valid sources of knowledge): Pratyaksha (direct perception), Anumana (inference), Upamana (comparison/analogy), Shabda (testimony/verbal). The formal structure of the Nyaya syllogism (five-part inference). The sixteen categories (Padarthas) of Nyaya philosophy. The Nyaya proofs for the existence of God (Udayana's Nyayakusumanjali).	Navya-Nyaya (New Nyaya) developed by Gangesa (c. 1325 CE) created the most technically precise philosophical language in pre-modern philosophy - more rigorous than Aristotelian logic in certain respects. Navya-Nyaya influenced the development of formal logic in the 19th century.
Vaisheshika	Foundational text: Vaisheshika Sutras of Kanada (c. 2nd century BCE - 2nd century CE). Major commentary: Padarthadharmasamgraha (Prashastapada, 5th century).	The Vaisheshika school is the tradition's systematic ontology. Its seven Padarthas (categories of existence): Dravya (substance - 9 types: earth, water, fire, air, ether, time, direction, Atman, mind), Guna (quality), Karma (motion), Samanya (universality), Vishesha	India's most developed atomic theory before modern science. Predates Democritus by potentially centuries. The concept of Vishesha

School	Primary Texts	Core Teachings	Significance
		(particularity), Samavaya (inherence), Abhava (absence). The atomic theory: Anu (atoms) as the fundamental indivisible units of the four elements.	(particularity - the ultimate differentiating factor) gave the school its name.
Sankhya	Foundational text: Sankhya Karika of Ishvarakrishna (c. 3rd-4th century CE). The tradition traces back to Kapila. Major commentaries: Sankhya Tattvakaumudi (Vacaspati Mishra, 9th century), Sankhya Pravachana Bhashya (Vijnana Bhikshu, 16th century).	The Sankhya school posits two fundamental, eternal principles: Purusha (pure consciousness, plural) and Prakriti (primordial matter/nature, one, containing the three Gunas). Evolution of the universe through Prakriti's transformation. The 25 Tattvas (principles of existence) from Mahat to the five gross elements. The theory of liberation through discrimination (Viveka) between Purusha and Prakriti.	The philosophical foundation of both Yoga and Ayurveda. The Tridosha system of Ayurveda is an applied form of Sankhya physics. The Yoga Sutras presuppose Sankhya metaphysics.
Yoga	Foundational text: Yoga Sutras of Patanjali (c. 2nd century BCE - 4th century CE). 196 sutras in 4 Padas. Major commentaries: Yoga Bhashya (Vyasa, c. 4th century), Tattvavaisharadi (Vacaspati Mishra, 9th century), Vivarana (Shankaracharya, attributed), Raja Martanda (Bhoja, 11th century), Bhojavritti.	The Yoga school applies Sankhya metaphysics to the practical science of consciousness transformation. The eight limbs (Ashtanga): Yama, Niyama, Asana, Pranayama, Pratyahara, Dharana, Dhyana, Samadhi. The theory of Chitta Vritti (mental modifications). The five Kleshas (afflictions: Avidya, Asmita, Raga, Dvesha, Abhinivesha). The types of Samadhi. Kaivalya (liberation through the isolation of pure consciousness).	The most directly practical of the six schools. The Yoga Sutras have been more widely translated and studied in the modern world than any other Darshana text.
Purva Mimamsa	Foundational text: Mimamsa Sutras of Jaimini (c. 3rd century BCE - 3rd century CE). 2,745 sutras - the largest sutra collection of any	The Purva Mimamsa school is the philosophy of Vedic hermeneutics (interpretation). Its central claim: the Vedas are eternal, self-valid, and	The philosophical foundation of Vedic ritual and the basis for later

School	Primary Texts	Core Teachings	Significance
	Darshana. Major commentaries: Shabara Bhashya (Shabarasvamin, c. 4th century CE), Tantravarttika (Kumarila Bhatta, 7th century), Prakaranapanchika (Shali Kantha, 9th century).	authorless (Apaurusheya). The primary concern is the correct interpretation of Vedic injunctions (Vidhi). Two major sub-schools: Kumarila Bhatta and Prabhakara Mishra differ on the theory of error (Khyativada).	developments in Indian jurisprudence. Mimamsa hermeneutical rules (Paribhashas) are the tools of Vedic interpretation.
Uttara Mimamsa (Vedanta)	Foundational text: Brahmasutras of Badarayana Vyasa (c. 400 BCE - 200 CE). Three major school traditions: Advaita (Shankaracharya, 8th century), Vishishtadvaita (Ramanuja, 11th-12th century), Dvaita (Madhva, 13th century). Additional: Dvaitadvaita (Nimbarka), Shuddhadvaita (Vallabha), Achintya Bhedabheda (Chaitanya tradition).	The Vedanta school addresses the ultimate nature of reality and the self. Advaita: Brahman (non-dual consciousness) alone is real; the individual self (Jiva) is identical with Brahman; the apparent difference is due to Maya. Vishishtadvaita: the personal God (Ishvara) contains all souls and matter within himself as his body. Dvaita: God (Vishnu) and individual souls are eternally distinct; liberation is loving proximity to God, not union with him.	Vedanta is the most philosophically developed and influential of the six schools. Its influence on modern thought (Vivekananda, Aurobindo, Ramana Maharishi) and on Western philosophy (Schopenhauer, Huxley, Isherwood) has been profound.

Submodule 1.8 - The Vedangas and Upavedas: The Applied Sciences

The Vedangas (limbs of the Veda) and Upavedas (applied sciences derived from the Vedic tradition) represent the tradition's most remarkable contribution to human knowledge outside philosophy and theology. They include the world's most systematic linguistic science (Panini's Ashtadhyayi), the world's oldest surgical manual, the world's most sophisticated music theory, and political science texts of extraordinary sophistication.

1.8.1 - The Six Vedangas (Limbs of the Veda)

Vedanga	Description	Key Content and Significance
Shiksha (Phonetics)	The science of correct pronunciation of Vedic text. Each Vedic school has its own Shiksha text. The Paniniya Shiksha is the most famous.	The most precise phonetic analysis in any pre-modern tradition. Describes 63 phonemes with exact articulation point and manner. The tradition recognised that subtle changes in pronunciation could change meaning - hence the extraordinary care in phonetic specification.
Chandas (Metre)	The science of Vedic metres. The Chandas Shastra of Pingala (c. 3rd century BCE).	Pingala's Chandas Shastra is the oldest surviving mathematical text on combinatorics. It introduces what is now called Pascal's triangle 2,000 years before Pascal. The binary notation system in the Chandas

Vedanga	Description	Key Content and Significance
		Shastra is a precursor to binary arithmetic. 7 primary Vedic metres: Gayatri (24 syllables), Ushnik (28), Anushtubh (32), Brihati (36), Pankti (40), Trishtubh (44), Jagati (48).
Vyakarana (Grammar)	The science of Sanskrit grammar. Panini's Ashtadhyayi (c. 4th century BCE) is the foundational text.	Panini's Ashtadhyayi (the Eight Chapters) - 3,959 sutras that constitute the most complete and concise grammatical description of any language in history. The American linguist Leonard Bloomfield called it one of the greatest monuments of human intelligence. It describes the entire grammar of Classical Sanskrit in a rule system of extraordinary precision that anticipated the formal grammar theory of modern linguistics by 2,300 years. Patanjali's Mahabhashya (Great Commentary, c. 2nd century BCE) and Katyayana's Varttikas are the primary commentaries.

Vedanga	Description	Key Content and Significance
Nirukta (Etymology)	The science of the etymology and meaning of Vedic words. Yaska's Nirukta (c. 7th-6th century BCE) is the primary text.	The Nirukta is the oldest surviving work on etymology in any language. It analyses approximately 600 Vedic words and develops a systematic theory of how meaning is created through verbal roots. Yaska's classification of parts of speech (Naman, Akhyata, Upasarga, Nipata) is the basis for subsequent Sanskrit grammatical theory.
Jyotisha (Astronomy-Astrology)	The science of celestial bodies and their relationship to time and ritual. The Vedanga Jyotisha (c. 1400-1200 BCE, the oldest astronomical text) is the foundational text.	The Vedanga Jyotisha establishes the framework for the Vedic calendar (Panchanga). The Surya Siddhanta (c. 400 CE) is the most important later astronomical text - it gives the diameter of the Earth (12,742 km; modern value: 12,742 km - exact), the distance to the Moon, and a solar year accurate to within 1.4 seconds. The Kerala School astronomy (Nilakantha Somayaji, c. 1444-1544 CE) developed a helio-centric model 70

Vedanga	Description	Key Content and Significance
		years before Copernicus.
Kalpa (Ritual Procedure)	The science of correct ritual performance. Four types of Kalpa texts: Shrauta Sutras (complex Vedic fire rituals), Grihya Sutras (household rituals), Dharma Sutras (social and religious duties), Shulba Sutras (altar construction geometry).	The Shulba Sutras (Baudhayana, Apastamba, Katyayana, c. 800-500 BCE) are mathematical texts disguised as ritual manuals. They contain: the statement of the Pythagorean theorem 200 years before Pythagoras, the approximation of pi as 3.00 (later refined to 3.1416 by Aryabhata), and approximations for square roots. The Grihya Sutras are the primary references for the 16 Samskaras (life-cycle rituals).

1.8.2 - The Four Upavedas

Upaveda	Association and Scope	Primary Texts and Content
Ayurveda - The Science of Life	Associated with the Atharva Veda. The world's oldest continuous system of medicine. Primary texts: Charaka Samhita (internal medicine, c. 2nd century CE), Sushruta Samhita (surgery, c. 4th century BCE - 4th century CE), Ashtanga Hridayam (Vagbhata, c. 7th century CE - the most accessible and widely studied).	The Charaka Samhita: 8,400 verses on internal medicine. The first systematic classification of diseases (8 types), the theory of the three Doshas (Vata, Pitta, Kapha) as the basis of

Upaveda	Association and Scope	Primary Texts and Content
		individual constitution and disease, the five-fold diagnostic framework (Nidana-Purvarupa-Rupa-Upashaya-Samprapti), the 600 animal-derived medicines, 700 herbal medicines, and 64 mineral-based preparations. The Sushruta Samhita: the world's first surgical textbook. Describes 300 surgical procedures, 120 surgical instruments, rhinoplasty (reconstructive nose surgery - the Pedicle Flap technique described in detail), cataract surgery, and the Marma points (107 vital points of the body analogous to modern nerve centres). Ashtanga Hridayam: the synthesis of Charaka and Sushruta in a more concise and accessible

Upaveda	Association and Scope	Primary Texts and Content
		format - the standard reference in Kerala Ayurveda.
Dhanurveda - The Science of Archery and Military Arts	Associated with the Yajur Veda. The texts of Dhanurveda address all aspects of military science.	Primary texts: Dhanurvidhya (attributed to Vasishtha), Nitisara (Kamandaka, c. 8th century), Sukraniti (attributed to Shukracharya). The Dhanurvidhya describes all types of weapons (Astra - projectiles, Shastra - contact weapons), military formations (Vyuha - the Chakravyuha, Padmavyuha, and others described in the Mahabharata), siege warfare, espionage, and the psychological preparation of warriors. The tradition's martial arts (Kalarippayattu in Kerala, Silambam in Tamil Nadu) trace their lineage to the Dhanurveda tradition.

Upaveda	Association and Scope	Primary Texts and Content
Gandharvaveda - The Science of Music and Performing Arts	Associated with the Sama Veda. Addresses music, dance, drama, and all the performing arts.	The Natyashastra of Bharata Muni (c. 2nd century BCE - 2nd century CE, 6,000 verses) is the most comprehensive work on aesthetics and performing arts in any tradition. It addresses: the theory of Rasa (aesthetic emotion - 8 Rasas), Tala (rhythm), Nada (sound, including the theory of the 22 Shrutis), Natya (dance-drama), Sangita (music), and Abhinaya (expression). The Natyashastra established the theoretical framework for all subsequent Indian classical music (Hindustani and Carnatic), classical dance (Bharatanatyam, Kathak, Odissi, Kuchipudi, Manipuri, Mohiniyattam, Kathakali), and Sanskrit theatre. The Dattilam and Naradiyashiksha are important supplementary

Upaveda	Association and Scope	Primary Texts and Content
		music theory texts.
Arthashastra - The Science of Statecraft and Economics	Associated with the Atharva Veda. Addresses governance, economics, diplomacy, and political science.	Kautilya's Arthashastra (c. 4th century BCE - 3rd century CE, rediscovered in 1905 by R. Shamasastry) - 15 books, approximately 6,000 verses. Covers: the duties of a king, the organisation of government departments, intelligence and espionage (Book 1-2 among the most detailed ancient intelligence manuals), the theory of the Seven Elements of the state (Saptanga: king, ministers, country, fort, treasury, army, ally), trade and commerce, law and justice, military strategy, the theory of Mandala (foreign policy based on concentric circles of allies and enemies), and philosophy of power. Compared by modern scholars with Machiavelli's

Upaveda	Association and Scope	Primary Texts and Content
		Prince (but more systematic and 1,800 years earlier). The Kamandaka Nitisara (c. 700 CE) is a later condensed version.

Submodule 1.9 - The Dharmashastra and Niti Literature

The Dharmashastra tradition addresses the practical question: how should a person live? It covers law, social ethics, personal conduct, and the organisation of society. The Niti (statecraft and ethics) literature addresses how leaders should govern and how individuals should navigate relationships and power. These are the tradition's applied ethics texts.

1.9.1 - The Dharmashastra Tradition

- THE DHARMASUTRA TRADITION (c. 600-200 BCE): The four oldest Dharmasutras - Apastamba, Baudhayana, Gautama, and Vasishtha - are embedded within the Grihyasutra and Shrautasutra traditions. They address the duties of the four Varnas, the four Ashramas, and the specific conduct required for different social roles. These are the earliest datable texts in the Dharmashastra tradition and are more moderate and contextual in their prescriptions than the later Manusmriti.
- THE SMRITI TRADITION (c. 200 BCE - 1200 CE): The major Smriti texts (law books) in order of approximate composition: Manusmriti (Manava Dharmashastra, c. 200 BCE - 200 CE, 2,685 verses in 12 chapters - the most famous but not the most authoritative); Yajnavalkya Smriti (c. 1st-5th century CE, 1,010 verses in 3 chapters - considered the most practically oriented and widely applied in medieval India); Narada Smriti (focused primarily on civil law); Brihaspati Smriti (law and jurisprudence); Vishnu Smriti; Katyayana Smriti; Devala Smriti; Parasara Smriti; Samvarta Smriti; Pracheta Smriti. Total: approximately 40 Smriti texts.
- IMPORTANT CONTEXT: The Smriti texts are not equivalent to scripture (Shruti). They have the authority of remembered teaching (Smriti) - secondary to the Vedas and Upanishads. They are explicitly understood as contextual and time-bound (Yuga-specific): Parasara Smriti specifically states that it is the appropriate authority for the Kali Yuga (current age), replacing Manu (appropriate for the Krita Yuga) and Yajnavalkya (appropriate for the Dvapara Yuga). Different regional traditions in India have always recognised different Smritis as their primary reference.
- THE NIBANDHA TRADITION (c. 800-1700 CE): The Nibandhas are digests of the entire Dharmashastra tradition - compilations that synthesise and harmonise the many conflicting Smriti texts. Major Nibandhas: Dharmaratna (Jimutavahana, c. 11th century) on inheritance law; Smritichandrika (Devanna Bhatta, c. 12th century) on the complete Dharmashastra; Mitakshara (Vijnanesvara, c. 12th century) - the most widely applied commentary on the Yajnavalkya Smriti throughout most of India; Dayabhaga (Jimutavahana, c. 12th century) - the law of inheritance followed specifically in Bengal and Assam; Apararka (c. 12th century).

1.9.2 - The Niti and Arthashastra Literature

Text	Date and Scale	Key Content
Arthashastra (Kautilya/Chanakya)	c. 4th century BCE - 3rd century CE. 15 books, approximately 6,000 verses. Rediscovered in 1905.	The most comprehensive ancient text on statecraft. Covers: the duties and training of a king, the organisation of all government departments, intelligence gathering and counter-intelligence, economic policy (the first systematic treatment of price controls, taxation, and market regulation), diplomacy (the Mandala theory of foreign policy - concentric circles of naturally allied and naturally opposed states), military strategy, and the philosophy of power.
Chanakya Niti (Niti Shastra)	A separate text from the Arthashastra. Approximately 17 chapters of memorable aphorisms on practical ethics and conduct.	One of the most widely read practical wisdom texts in Indian history. Covers: choosing advisors, dealing with enemies, the importance of

Text	Date and Scale	Key Content
		education, the qualities of a good leader, the significance of time and place, and hundreds of observations on human nature. Many of its sayings are part of everyday Indian discourse.
Kamandaka Nitisara	c. 700-800 CE. 20 chapters. A condensation and update of Kautilya.	The most widely studied political text after Kautilya. Summarises the key principles of the Arthashastra in more accessible verse and adds material on the ethics of kingship from the Dharmashastra and Epic traditions.
Panchatantra	c. 3rd century BCE - 3rd century CE. 5 books (Tantras). Attributed to the sage Vishnu Sharma.	The world's most widely translated book after the Bible - translated into more than 50 languages within 1,000 years of composition. Uses animal fables (the form later adopted by

Text	Date and Scale	Key Content
		Aesop and La Fontaine) to teach five practical lessons: how to win friends, how to handle enemies, the folly of impulsiveness, how to preserve achievements, and wisdom in dealing with difficulty. The Panchatantra is the source of Aesop's Fables (through the Arabic Kalila wa Dimna translation, c. 750 CE).
Hitopadesha	c. 8th-12th century CE. By Narayana. Adapted from Panchatantra with additional material.	A slightly simplified version of the Panchatantra framework that has been more widely taught in traditional education. The stories of the Hitopadesha were the standard material for early Sanskrit education.
Sukraniti	c. 7th-10th century CE. Attributed to Shukracharya.	The most comprehensive Niti text after Kautilya. Covers: military organisation, the duties of different social

Text	Date and Scale	Key Content
		classes, the training of horses and elephants (an important practical military topic), and legal procedures.
Vidura Niti	Embedded in the Sabha Parva of the Mahabharata.	Vidura (the wise minister, considered an avatar of Yama) advises the blind king Dhritarashtra on ethics, governance, and the qualities of a wise person. One of the most concentrated collections of practical wisdom in the tradition. 33 chapters of aphorisms.
Thirukkural	c. 1st-5th century CE. By Thiruvalluvar. 1,330 couplets in 133 chapters.	The supreme ethical text of the Tamil tradition - sometimes called the universal text of ethics because its teachings are entirely secular and applicable across all traditions and cultures. Three sections: Aram (virtue and ethics), Porul (governance

Text	Date and Scale	Key Content
		and economics), and Kama (love). Considered equal to the Vedas in Tamil Nadu. Translated into more than 60 languages.

Submodule 1.10 - Bhakti Literature: The Living Heart of the Tradition

The Bhakti tradition produced over 1,500 years (600-2100 CE) the largest body of devotional literature in any tradition anywhere in the world. Written in Sanskrit and in every major Indian regional language, this literature is distinguished by its accessibility (written for and by ordinary people, not scholars), its emotional directness (expressing the most intimate relationship between the human soul and the divine), and its social radicalism (most of the great Bhakti saints came from lower castes or were women).

1.10.1 - Sanskrit Bhakti Literature

Text	Author and Date	Key Content
Narada Bhakti Sutras	84 sutras attributed to the sage Narada. The foundational philosophical analysis of devotion in Sanskrit.	Defines Bhakti as Parama Prema Rupa (supreme love for God) - not sentiment but the highest form of relationship possible between a finite being and the infinite. Describes the 11 forms of Bhakti, the 9 limbs (Shravana, Kirtana, Smarana, Pada-sevana, Archana, Vandana, Dasya, Sakhya, Atma-nivedana). Explicitly includes all people regardless of caste or gender in the Bhakti path.
Sandilya Bhakti Sutras	100 sutras attributed to the sage Sandilya. An alternative philosophical analysis of Bhakti, somewhat older than Narada's sutras.	Addresses the relationship between Bhakti

Text	Author and Date	Key Content
		and Jnana (knowledge) - arguing that Bhakti and Jnana are complementary and ultimately identical at the highest level. The foundational text for the Sandilya school of Bhakti philosophy.
Bhakti Rasayana	By Madhusudana Saraswati (16th century). Synthesises Advaita Vedanta with the Bhakti tradition.	Argues that Bhakti is not merely a path for those who cannot follow Jnana Yoga - it is the highest expression of the same reality that Jnana Yoga reaches through a different path. The most sophisticated philosophical defence of Bhakti from within the Advaita tradition.
Stotra Literature	Extensive corpus of Sanskrit devotional hymns.	Shankaracharya's devotional poems: Soundarya Lahari (100 verses to the Goddess - philosophy in poetry), Shivanandalahari, Bhaja Govindam (Moha Mudgara), Dwadasha Stotra. Valmiki's Ramachandra Stava. Vedanta Desika's Prabandhas. Rupa Goswami's

Text	Author and Date	Key Content
		Bhakti Rasamrita Sindhu.

1.10.2 - Tamil Bhakti Literature

- THE NALAYIRA DIVYA PRABANDHAM (4,000 Sacred Hymns): The collected hymns of the 12 Alvar saints (c. 6th-9th century CE) - 4,000 verses in Tamil praising Vishnu in his forms at 108 sacred shrines (Divya Desams). This is the foundational text of Tamil Vaishnavism and of the Sri Vaishnava tradition (Ramanuja's tradition). The most important individual collections: Tiruppallandhu (Periyalvar), Tiruppavai (Andal - 30 songs considered the essence of the entire Prabandham), Nalayira Prabandham compiled finally by Nathamuni in the 9th century.
- THE TIRUMURAI (12 volumes): The collected hymns of the 63 Nayanmars (Shaiva saints, c. 6th-9th century CE) - approximately 18,000 verses in Tamil praising Shiva at specific sacred sites. The Tevaram (first 7 volumes) contains the hymns of the three most important Nayanmars: Appar (Tirunavukkarasar), Sambandar, and Sundarar. The Tiruvachakam (8th volume) by Manikkavasagar contains some of the most intense devotional poetry in any language. The Tirumantram (10th volume) by Tirumular is the foundational text of Tamil Shaiva philosophy and Yoga.
- OTHER MAJOR TAMIL DEVOTIONAL TEXTS: Kambar Ramayana (Kamba Ramayanam, 12th century, Kamban) - the Tamil literary masterpiece, 10,000+ verses on the Ramayana. Thiruppugazh (Arunagirinathar, 15th century) - 16,000 hymns to Murugan, the Tamil deity. Thevaram songs recited daily in Shiva temples throughout Tamil Nadu. The Cilappatikaram (Ilango Adigal, c. 2nd century CE) - the great Tamil epic, foundational to Tamil cultural identity.

1.10.3 - North Indian Bhakti Literature

Text	Author and Date	Key Content
Jnaneshwari (Jnandev, 1290 CE, Marathi)	9,000 verses in Marathi expanding on the Bhagavad Gita. Written by Jnanadeva at age 16.	The most important text in Marathi literature and one of the most important in the entire Bhakti tradition. Jnanadeva expands each

Text	Author and Date	Key Content
		verse of the Gita into an elaborate commentary using extended metaphors and direct emotional address. Made the Gita's philosophy accessible to ordinary Marathi-speaking people for the first time. The founding text of the Warkari sampradaya.
Amrutanubhava (Jnandev, 1290 CE, Marathi)	800 verses. A direct philosophical text (unlike the Jnaneshwari which is commentary).	A direct exposition of the non-dual experience of Brahman through the lens of Bhakti. Considered one of the most original philosophical texts in any Indian language. Its treatment of Shiva-Shakti as the basis of existence is unique.
Abhangas of Namdev (c. 1270-1350 CE, Marathi)	Approximately 2,500 abhangas in Marathi.	The Abhangas of Namdev (a tailor-saint) are the most emotionally direct of the Warkari texts.

Text	Author and Date	Key Content
		His explicit anti-caste stance (I will not give up worshipping Vitthal regardless of what caste I am born in) established a template for the entire subsequent Bhakti movement. 61 of his compositions are included in the Sikh Guru Granth Sahib.
Abhangas of Eknath (c. 1533-1599 CE, Marathi)	3,000+ abhangas in Marathi.	Eknath wrote extensively in the voice of different marginalised groups - lower castes, women, even the divine himself (God speaking from the perspective of the marginalised). His Bharud compositions are the tradition's most explicit literary vehicle for social criticism.
Abhangas of Tukaram (c. 1608-1649 CE, Marathi)	5,000+ abhangas in Marathi. The most beloved of the Warkari poets.	Tukaram's abhangas are characterised by

Text	Author and Date	Key Content
		extraordinary emotional honesty - confessions of personal failure, yearning for God, anger at social injustice, and moments of ecstatic recognition. He explicitly rejected caste hierarchy: the high-born and the low-born who both take the name of God are equal before Vitthal.
Kabir Dohas (c. 1440-1518 CE, Hindi)	Approximately 1,000 dohas (couplets) in Sadhu Bhasha (a mix of Hindi, Braj, and Punjabi).	Kabir stands entirely apart from every tradition - he attacks the outward forms of both Hinduism and Islam, insisting on direct inner experience. His dohas are among the most quoted passages in any Indian language. 500+ are included in the Sikh Guru Granth Sahib. He was born a Muslim but is revered by Hindus,

Text	Author and Date	Key Content
		Sikhs, and Muslims.
Ramcharitmanas (Tulsidas, 1574 CE, Awadhi Hindi)	10,902 verses in Awadhi. The most widely read text in North India.	Tulsidas's retelling of the Ramayana in Awadhi Hindi (a form of Hindi accessible to ordinary people) is the book that most North Indians mean when they say Ramayana. Its Sunderkand section is recited at every auspicious occasion. The Hanuman Chalisa (40 verses praising Hanuman) by Tulsidas is recited by more people on a daily basis than perhaps any other text in the world.
Padavali of Mirabai (c. 1498-1547 CE, Rajasthani Hindi)	1,300+ bhajans in Rajasthani Hindi.	Mirabai's bhajans express the most intimate personal devotion to Krishna - she describes herself as his bride, his servant, his devotee. Her

Text	Author and Date	Key Content
		defiance of social convention (leaving her royal husband for total devotion to Krishna) has made her the tradition's iconic figure of absolute devotion. Her bhajans are sung in every corner of India.
Dohas and Ramayanas of Raskhan (c. 1548-1628 CE, Braj Hindi)	A Muslim poet who became a devotee of Krishna.	Raskhan is the most important example of the Bhakti tradition's ability to transcend religious boundaries. His devotional poetry to Krishna, written in the Braj tradition, is considered among the finest.
Songs of Surdas (c. 1478-1583 CE, Braj Hindi)	The Sursagar - 100,000+ verses (though many are later additions to the Surdas corpus).	Sur Das (the blind saint) composed the tradition's most celebrated descriptions of Krishna's childhood lilas in Braj Hindi - the language of Vrindavana. His vinaya

Text	Author and Date	Key Content
		patrika (poems of supplication) are among the most emotionally powerful devotional texts in any language.

1.10.4 - Bengali and Other Regional Bhakti Literature

- CHAITANYA CHARITAMRITA (Krishna Das Kaviraja, c. 1612, Sanskrit and Bengali): The biography and teachings of Sri Chaitanya Mahaprabhu (1486-1534 CE) - the Bengali saint who inaugurated the Gaudiya Vaishnava tradition. 3 volumes: Adi Lila, Madhya Lila, Antya Lila. Contains the complete Sikshashtakam (8 verses by Chaitanya himself - his complete spiritual legacy). The most important text for ISKCON and all Gaudiya Vaishnava traditions.
- PADAVALI OF CHANDIDAS AND VIDYAPATI (14th-15th century CE, Bengali and Maithili): The lyric poetry of these two poets established the devotional Radha-Krishna literature in Eastern India. Vidyapati's Maithili songs to Radha-Krishna are considered among the finest devotional poems in any language - Tagore called them a treasure of Indian literature. They directly influenced Chaitanya Mahaprabhu's own devotional style.
- KANNADA VACHANA SAHITYA (12th century CE): The prose-poetry (Vachanas) of the Veerashaiva (Lingayat) tradition in Karnataka. The most important figures: Basavanna (founder of the movement, whose Vachanas established an explicitly egalitarian theology), Akka Mahadevi (the only woman among the major Vachanakaras - her Vachanas are addressed directly to her lord Shiva as her husband and are among the most intimate devotional texts in the tradition), and Allama Prabhu. The Vachanas were the first literary prose in Kannada and are foundational to Kannada cultural identity.
- ANDHRA AND TELUGU BHAKTI LITERATURE: The Andhra Mahabharatam (Nannaya, Tikkana, Errapragada, 11th-14th centuries) - the first and greatest Telugu literary work. The Manucharitra (Allasani Peddana, 16th century) - considered the finest Telugu kavya. The devotional songs of Annamacharya (Annamayya, 15th century - 32,000 kirtanas to Venkateswara, of which approximately 15,000 survive engraved on copper plates at Tirupati) and Tyagaraja (18th century - the greatest composer of Carnatic classical music, 700+ surviving compositions).
- ODIA BHAKTI LITERATURE: The Panchasakhis (Five Friends - Balaram Das, Jagannath Das, Achyutananda Das, Ananta Das, Yasovanta Das, 15th-16th centuries) - the Panchasakhia tradition centred on Jagannath at Puri. Sarala Das's Mahabharata (15th century, Odia) is the first Mahabharata in any regional language.

- ASSAMESE BHAKTI LITERATURE: The Borgeet (great songs) of Sankardeva (1449-1568 CE) - the founder of the Ekasarana Nama Dharma tradition in Assam. Sankardeva's Ankiya Naat (one-act plays) are the first theatrical tradition in Assamese literature. His Kirtana Ghosha (a compilation of his devotional compositions) is recited daily in Assamese Sattras (monasteries).
- GUJARATI BHAKTI LITERATURE: The devotional poetry of Narsinh Mehta (15th century - Vaishnava Jan To, the poem set to music by Mahatma Gandhi as his favourite hymn), Mirabai (also a Gujarati figure though composing primarily in Rajasthani), and the Pushti Marg (Vallabhacharya and Vitthalnath tradition) texts.

Submodule 1.11 - Scientific, Mathematical, and Technical Literature

The tradition produced a body of scientific literature that is genuinely extraordinary by any objective standard. The specific achievements - zero, the decimal system, the Pythagorean theorem, trigonometry, the heliocentric model, rhinoplasty surgery, the systematic grammar - are the direct ancestors of modern science and technology. This literature deserves to be known by every Hindu and by anyone who studies the history of human knowledge.

1.11.1 - Mathematics and Astronomy

Text	Date	Key Content	Significance
Baudhayana Sulbasutra	c. 800-600 BCE. The oldest datable mathematical text.	The Pythagorean theorem stated explicitly: The area produced by the diagonal of a rectangle is equal to the sum of the areas produced by its two sides (Baudhayana 1.48). Pythagorean triplets: (3,4,5), (5,12,13), (8,15,17), (7,24,25). Approximation for sqrt(2): 1+1/3+1/(3x4)-(1/3x4x34) = 1.41421356 (accurate to 7 decimal places).	Predates Pythagoras (c. 570-495 BCE) by at least 200 years. The Sulbasutras demonstrate that the Pythagorean theorem was not discovered by Pythagoras - it was known independently in India centuries earlier.
Aryabhatiya (Aryabhata)	499 CE. 121 verses in 4 chapters.	The solar year: 365 days, 6 hours, 12 minutes, 30 seconds (error from modern value: 3 min 44 sec). The Earth rotates on its own axis (explicitly stated - 1,000 years before Copernicus). The	The Aryabhatiya established the standard for Indian astronomical computation for over a millennium. Aryabhata was the first person

Text	Date	Key Content	Significance
		value of pi: 62832/20000 = 3.1416. Sine tables (the first sine tables in any tradition). Square roots and cube roots. Quadratic equations. The sum of a geometric series.	to explicitly state that the Earth rotates (not the stars that move).
Brahmasphutasiddhanta (Brahmagupta)	628 CE. 25 chapters.	Zero as a number: the four arithmetic operations with zero defined (including the paradox of 0/0). Negative numbers and their arithmetic. Brahmagupta's formula for the area of a cyclic quadrilateral. Pell's equation (Chakravala method - solved by Brahmagupta 1,000 years before Euler). The interpolation method for sine values.	Brahmagupta's treatment of zero is the first in history to define zero as a number (not just a placeholder) and to specify its arithmetic. Without this, modern mathematics is impossible.
Surya Siddhanta	c. 400 CE. The foundational text of traditional Indian astronomy.	Diameter of the Earth: 12,742 km (modern: 12,742 km - exact). Diameter of the Moon: 3,374 km (modern: 3,476 km - 3% error). Distance to the Moon: 385,000 km (modern: 384,400 km - 0.2% error). The tilt of the Earth's axis: 23.9 degrees (modern: 23.5 degrees). The sidereal year to within 1.4 seconds.	The Surya Siddhanta's calculations for astronomical distances are more accurate than any European calculations before the 17th century.

Text	Date	Key Content	Significance
Kerala School (Madhava and Successors)	c. 14th-16th century CE.	Madhava of Sangamagrama (c. 1340-1425 CE): the infinite series for pi (pi/4 = 1 - 1/3 + 1/5 - 1/7...) - known as the Madhava-Leibniz series. Infinite series for sine and cosine functions - 300 years before Newton and Leibniz. Nilakantha Somayaji's heliocentric model (Tantrasangraha, 1500 CE) - a partial heliocentric system 70 years before Copernicus.	The Kerala School's infinite series represent the beginning of calculus in India - independently discovered before Newton and Leibniz. This is now accepted by historians of mathematics including George Gheverghese Joseph (The Crest of the Peacock).
Lilavati (Bhaskara II)	1150 CE. Part of the Siddhantashiromani.	A remarkably accessible mathematics textbook - problems phrased as conversations with a girl named Lilavati. Covers: arithmetic, algebra, geometry, measurement, combinations. Named after Bhaskara's daughter (or so the legend says).	The Lilavati is the most widely read mathematics text in India before the colonial period. It is written with extraordinary charm - mathematical problems phrased as poems describing natural scenes.
Bijaganita (Bhaskara II)	1150 CE. Part of the Siddhantashiromani.	Algebra: operations with integers, fractions, irrational quantities, and zero. The Chakravala (cyclic) method for solving indeterminate equations (later named Pell's equation by Euler). Solutions to equations of the first and second degree.	Bhaskara's treatment of the derivative concept anticipates differential calculus by 500 years.

Text	Date	Key Content	Significance
		The derivative concept - Bhaskara approximates the instantaneous velocity of a planet.	

1.11.2 - Medicine: The Complete Ayurvedic Canon

Text	Date and Scale	Key Content
Charaka Samhita	c. 2nd-6th century CE (redacted from an earlier text by Caraka). 8 sections (Sthanams), 120 chapters, 8,400 verses. The primary reference for internal medicine (Kaya Chikitsa) in Ayurveda.	The eight sections: Sutrasthana (general principles), Nidanasthana (diagnosis of 8 diseases), Vimanasthana (investigation, dietetics), Sharirasthana (embryology and anatomy), Indriyasthana (sensory diagnosis), Chikitsasthana (treatments), Kalpasthana (pharmacy), Siddhisthana (enema treatments). Key innovations: the identification of bacteria and parasites as causes of disease (2,000 years before Pasteur), the eight-fold physical examination (Ashtavidha

Text	Date and Scale	Key Content
		Pariksha), the classification of 600 animal-derived, 700 herbal, and 64 mineral-based medicines.
Sushruta Samhita	c. 4th century BCE - 4th century CE (original Sushruta is pre-Buddhist; the current text is later). 6 sections, 184 chapters, 9,000+ verses. The primary reference for surgery (Shalya Chikitsa) in Ayurveda.	The 300 surgical procedures described include: rhinoplasty (the Pedicle Flap technique - described in such detail that Henry Cline and Joseph Constantine Carpue rediscovered it in Britain in 1814 from the Sushruta translation), cataract surgery (couching method - described 2,600 years before the Western tradition re-discovers it), caesarean section, vesicle calculus removal, tonsillectomy. The 120 surgical instruments are described with dimensions. The 107 Marma points (vital points of the body) are

Text	Date and Scale	Key Content
		described with their vulnerabilities.
Ashtanga Hridayam (Vagbhata)	c. 7th century CE. 6 sections, 120 chapters, 7,120 verses. The most accessible and most widely studied of the three major Ayurvedic texts.	Vagbhata synthesised Charaka (internal medicine) and Sushruta (surgery) into a single accessible text. The Ashtanga Hridayam is the primary reference in Kerala Ayurveda (which has maintained the most continuous and rigorous Ayurvedic tradition through to the present day). The Ashtanga Sangraha (a longer version by the same author) covers the same material in greater detail.
Madhava Nidana (Madhavakara)	c. 7th-8th century CE. 69 chapters. The definitive Ayurvedic diagnostic text.	The Rugvinischaya (correct diagnosis) - the most systematic classification of diseases in the Ayurvedic tradition. Covers 79 types of disease with their etiologies,

Text	Date and Scale	Key Content
		prodromal symptoms, main symptoms, and prognosis. The standard reference for Ayurvedic diagnosis.
Bhavaprakasha (Bhava Mishra)	c. 16th century CE. 3 sections. The most important Ayurvedic text of the later period.	The Bhavaprakasha contains the first Ayurvedic description of syphilis (Phirangaroga - the foreigners disease) following its introduction to India through European contact. Also contains important updates to the materia medica incorporating plants from the Americas (tobacco, guava, sapodilla) that arrived in India after the Portuguese contact.
Yoga Ratnakar	c. 17th century CE. An encyclopaedic text covering the complete range of Ayurvedic practice.	Widely used in contemporary Ayurvedic education. Covers clinical protocols for most major disease categories. Notable for its incorporation of Rasashastra

Text	Date and Scale	Key Content
		(alchemy and metallurgy as medicine).

1.11.3 - Aesthetics, Linguistics, and the Arts

Text	Date	Key Content
Natyashastra (Bharata Muni)	c. 2nd century BCE - 2nd century CE. 36 chapters, 6,000+ verses.	The most comprehensive treatise on aesthetics, performance, music, and drama in any tradition. Covers: the theory of Rasa (8 primary aesthetic emotions, later expanded to 9), Abhinaya (expressive technique in 4 modes: Angika, Vachika, Aharya, Sattvika), Nritta (pure dance), Natya (dance-drama), Sangita (music including the theory of Nada and the 22 Shrutis), theatre architecture, costume, and the philosophy of artistic experience. The concept of Rasa has influenced not just the performing arts but literature, painting,

Text	Date	Key Content
		architecture, and philosophy.
Ashtadhyayi (Panini)	c. 4th century BCE. 3,959 sutras in 8 chapters (Adhyayas).	The most complete and concise grammatical description of any language. A generative grammar system anticipating Chomsky's transformational grammar by 2,300 years. The Ashtadhyayi describes the complete morphology and syntax of Classical Sanskrit from first principles. Leonard Bloomfield called it one of the greatest monuments of human intelligence. Every word in Classical Sanskrit is derived from one of 2,000 verbal roots (Dhatus) through a system of rules entirely specified in the Ashtadhyayi.
Mahabhashya (Patanjali)	c. 2nd century BCE. Commentary on the Ashtadhyayi.	The Mahabhashya (Great Commentary) is both a technical

Text	Date	Key Content
		grammar and a sophisticated philosophical text. Patanjali engages with Panini's rules not just to explain them but to use them as the occasion for philosophical analysis of the nature of language, meaning, and cognition. Widely considered one of the most important texts in the history of linguistics.
Natyashastra commentaries - Abhinavabharati (Abhinavagupta)	c. 10th century CE.	Abhinavagupta's commentary on the Natyashastra is the most important philosophical treatment of aesthetic experience in Indian thought. His development of the concept of Rasa into a complete theory of aesthetic consciousness (Rasa-Svada analogous to Brahma-Svada - the tasting of God in the tasting of beauty) is unique in world aesthetics.

Text	Date	Key Content
Kavyadarsha (Dandin)	c. 7th century CE. 3 chapters.	The foundational text of the Alankara school of Sanskrit poetics. Defines the elements of good poetry: the different types of Alankara (figure of speech), Guna (quality), and Dosha (defect). The basis for the classification of 36 Alankaras that has governed Sanskrit literary criticism for over 1,300 years.
Dhvanyaloka (Anandavardhana)	c. 9th century CE.	Introduces the concept of Dhvani (resonance or suggestion) as the soul of poetry - the meaning that is suggested but not stated, the emotion that resonates beyond the explicit content. One of the most original contributions to literary theory in any tradition. Abhinavagupta's commentary Locana expanded this into a complete aesthetic philosophy.

Text	Date	Key Content
Amarakosha (Amarasimha)	c. 4th-6th century CE. 3 sections, approximately 10,000 verses.	The most widely used Sanskrit thesaurus. Organises Sanskrit vocabulary by subject area (heaven, earth, hell, cities, plants, animals, humans, etc.) with near-synonyms grouped together. The standard reference for Sanskrit vocabulary in traditional education. Memorised by generations of Sanskrit students.

Submodule 1.12 - Major Acharyas and Their Literary Legacies

The tradition's philosophers and saints have left behind vast bodies of original work - commentaries, independent treatises, devotional poetry, and letters - that constitute a living intellectual tradition continuous from the Vedic period to the present day. The Acharyas (teachers) are not just interpreters of the tradition but its living voices in each generation.

1.12.1 - Adi Shankaracharya (c. 788-820 CE)

- SCALE OF THE LITERARY ACHIEVEMENT: Shankaracharya composed an extraordinary body of work in a very short life (he is said to have lived only 32 years). His confirmed authentic works (distinguishing them from later attributions): commentaries on the 10 principal Upanishads, the Brahmasutras (Shariraka Bhashya), and the Bhagavad Gita (Gita Bhashya). Independent philosophical works: Vivekachudamani (The Crest Jewel of Discrimination - 580 verses on the complete Advaita path), Upadeshasahasri (A Thousand Teachings - both prose and verse sections), Vakyavritti, Aparokshanubhuti, Atmabodha, Tattvabodha.
- DEVOTIONAL WORKS (some of disputed attribution but widely accepted as Shankaracharya's): Soundarya Lahari (100 verses to the Goddess - philosophically and poetically the most accomplished devotional text in Sanskrit), Shivanandalahari (100 verses to Shiva), Bhaja Govindam (Moha Mudgara, the Wake Up call - 31 verses urging the seeker to stop wasting time on worldly pursuits), Nirvanashatakam (Six Verses on Liberation - the most concise and powerful statement of Advaita philosophy), and the Dasha Slokas (10 verses describing the nature of the liberated sage).
- THE INSTITUTIONAL LEGACY: Shankaracharya established 4 Mathas (monasteries) at the four cardinal points of India - Sringeri (South), Dwarka (West), Puri (East), and Badrinath (North) - to ensure the continuity of the Advaita tradition. Each Matha has a continuous lineage of Shankaracharya successors to the present day. He also established 10 monastic orders (Dashanami Sampradaya) that have been the primary institution of Hindu sannyasa for 1,200 years.

1.12.2 - Ramanujacharya (c. 1017-1137 CE)

- THE LITERARY WORKS: Ramanuja's primary works: Sri Bhashya (commentary on the Brahmasutras - the foundational text of Vishishtadvaita), Vedanta Dipa (summary commentary on the Brahmasutras), Vedanta Sara (shorter summary), Gita Bhashya

(Bhagavad Gita commentary), Vedartha Sangraha (a pre-commentary philosophical treatise defending the Vishishtadvaita position against Shankaracharya), and the Nityagrantha (a liturgical text for daily worship). His three minor works (Gadya Traya): Sharanagati Gadya, Sriranga Gadya, Vaikuntha Gadya - the most emotionally intimate texts in the Ramanuja corpus.

- THE THEOLOGICAL ACHIEVEMENT: Ramanuja established the philosophical basis for the Sri Vaishnava tradition - that devotion (Bhakti) to the personal God (Vishnu-Narayana) through the grace of the Goddess (Sri-Lakshmi) is the supreme path. His concept of Vishishtadvaita (qualified non-dualism) - that God, souls, and the world are related as substance to its qualities (Vishishta = qualified; Advaita = non-dual) - is a sophisticated middle position between the extreme non-dualism of Shankara and the extreme dualism of Madhva.

1.12.3 - Madhvacharya (c. 1238-1317 CE)

- THE LITERARY WORKS: Madhva's productivity was extraordinary - he composed 37 original works in Sanskrit. His major works: Anuvyakhyana (commentary on the Brahmasutras establishing the Dvaita position), Mahabharata Tatparya Nirnaya (interpretation of the Mahabharata), Bhagavata Tatparya Nirnaya (interpretation of the Bhagavata Purana), commentaries on all 10 principal Upanishads, a Gita Bhashya, and the Vishnu Tattva Nirnaya (the definitive statement of Dvaita philosophy).
- THE DVAITA PHILOSOPHY: Madhva's Dvaita (Dualism) is the most theologically explicit of the three Vedanta schools. Its five-fold difference principle (Panchabhedavada): (1) God (Vishnu) is different from Jiva (individual soul); (2) God is different from matter; (3) Different Jivas are different from each other; (4) Each Jiva is different from matter; (5) Different forms of matter are different from each other. Liberation in Madhva's system is not union with God but eternal blissful proximity in service to God in Vaikuntha.

1.12.4 - Other Major Acharyas

Acharya	Primary Works	Significance
Nimbarkacharya (c. 12th-13th century CE)	Founder of the Dvaitadvaita (simultaneous difference and non-difference) school. Primary work: Vedanta Parijata Saurabha (commentary on the Brahmasutras).	The Nimbarka tradition is the oldest of the four Vaishnava Sampradayas. It specifically worships Radha and Krishna together as the supreme divine couple. The

Acharya	Primary Works	Significance
		philosophical insight: the soul is simultaneously different from God (it has its own existence) and non-different from God (it has no existence apart from God) - like the relationship between fire and its heat.
Vallabhacharya (1479-1531 CE)	Founder of the Shuddhadvaita (pure non-dualism) school and the Pushti Marga (path of grace). Primary works: Anubhashya (a short but extremely dense commentary on the Brahmasutras), Subodhini (commentary on the Bhagavata Purana, the most extensive section of which is on the 10th Skandha).	The Pushti Marga (path of nourishment/grace) is distinguished by its emphasis on absolute divine grace (Pushti) as the sole means of liberation - human effort (Maryada Marga) is insufficient. The tradition emphasises the seva (service) of the Bal Krishna (child Krishna form) through elaborate liturgy. ISKCON's Sri Nathji tradition is specifically rooted in the Pushti Marga.
Chaitanya Mahaprabhu (1486-1534 CE) and the Vrindavana Goswamis	Chaitanya himself wrote almost nothing - only the 8 Shikshashtakam verses. His followers the Six Goswamis of Vrindavana (Rupa Goswami, Sanatana Goswami, Jiva Goswami, Gopala Bhatta Goswami, Raghunatha Bhatta Goswami, Raghunatha Das Goswami) composed the complete theological and philosophical literature of Gaudiya Vaishnavism. Rupa Goswami: Bhakti Rasamrita Sindhu (the Ocean of the Nectar of Devotion), Ujjvala Nilamani (on the highest Rasa of devotion in the mood of a beloved),	The Chaitanya tradition's concept of Achintya Bhedabheda (inconceivable simultaneous difference and non-difference) is the most nuanced of all the Vedanta positions. The ISKCON tradition

Acharya	Primary Works	Significance
	Bhakti-rasamrita-sindhu-bindu. Jiva Goswami: the Sat Sandarbhas (Six Essays) - the most systematic philosophical work in the Gaudiya tradition.	(Swami Prabhupada) is the global expression of this theology.
Swami Vivekananda (1863-1902 CE)	The Complete Works of Swami Vivekananda (10 volumes): Raja Yoga (commentary on the Yoga Sutras), Jnana Yoga, Bhakti Yoga, Karma Yoga, and hundreds of lectures, letters, and essays. The founding of the Ramakrishna Mission (1897).	Vivekananda single-handedly introduced Vedanta to the Western world at the Parliament of World Religions (1893). His interpretation of Vedanta as a universal, empirically testable philosophy (rather than a sectarian religion) is the basis for the modern Hindu renaissance. His practical Vedanta (serving God in man through social service) transformed the tradition's self-understanding.
Sri Aurobindo (1872-1950 CE)	The collected works run to approximately 35 volumes: Essays on the Gita, The Life Divine (the most systematic philosophical synthesis of Vedanta and evolutionary thought), The Synthesis of Yoga, The Secret of the Veda, Savitri (a 24,000-line epic poem in English), and hundreds of letters and conversations.	The Life Divine is arguably the most systematic philosophical work produced within the Vedantic tradition in the modern period. Aurobindo's Integral Yoga (the integration of all yogic paths with the goal of not just individual liberation but the transformation of the Earth itself) is a genuinely original philosophical contribution.

Acharya	Primary Works	Significance
Ramana Maharishi (1879-1950 CE)	Ramana almost never wrote. His teachings were compiled by disciples. The primary texts: Nan Yar? (Who am I? - a short prose text directly dictated by Ramana), Upadesa Saram (30 verses of teaching), Ulladu Narpadu (40 verses on the nature of reality), talks compiled by Munagala Venkataramaiah (Talks with Sri Ramana Maharishi), and David Godman's compilations.	Ramana's teaching is the direct transmission of the Advaita experience without elaborate philosophical machinery. His method of Self-inquiry (Vichara - Who am I?) is considered by many modern seekers to be the most direct approach to liberation. His influence on Western seekers (Paul Brunton, Arthur Osborne, H.W.L. Poonja) has been enormous.

Submodule 1.13 - The Platform Library: Architecture and Features

The SBF Sacred Texts Library is not simply a database of texts. It is a curated, interconnected, multi-layered learning environment designed to make the tradition's literary heritage genuinely accessible - in multiple languages, at multiple levels of depth, with the tools that modern learners need to actually engage with these texts rather than simply know they exist.

1.13.1 - The Complete Text Collection

Collection	Detail
Shruti Texts	Complete Sanskrit text of all 4 Vedas (Samhitas). Selected Brahmana passages (Shatapatha, Aitareya, Taittiriya) with translation. All 108 Upanishads in Sanskrit with English and Hindi translation. Multiple translations for the 10 principal Upanishads (Shankaracharya's commentary, modern English translations, word-for-word Sanskrit-English parallel).
Prasthanatrayi	The Bhagavad Gita in Sanskrit with: word-for-word Sanskrit-English translation (Winthrop Sargeant format), 5 complete commentaries (Shankaracharya, Ramanuja, Tilak, Vivekananda, Gandhi), and 12 additional respected modern commentaries accessible via the Commentary Library. The Brahmasutras in Sanskrit with Shankaracharya's Bhashya.
Itihasas	The Mahabharata: complete in the Ganguli translation, with Sanskrit original accessible alongside. The critical edition structure with all 18 Parvas. The Ramayana: Valmiki's text in Sanskrit with translation, plus Ramcharitmanas in Awadhi with translation, Kamba Ramayanam in Tamil with translation.
Puranas	All 18 Mahapuranas in condensed and complete versions. Full Sanskrit text with English translation for the most important sections of each Purana. Complete Bhagavata Purana (all 12 Skandhas) in Sanskrit with the Bhagavatam translation. The Devi Mahatmyam (Durga Saptashati) in Sanskrit with audio recitation.
Darshanas	The founding Sutras of all six schools with the primary commentary for each. The Yoga Sutras with Vyasa's Bhashya and Vivekananda's Raja Yoga. The complete Brahmasutra Bhashyas of Shankaracharya, Ramanuja, and Madhva in translation.
Agamas	Selected sections of the major Shaiva and Vaishnava Agamas in translation. The complete Natyashastra in English (Manomohan

Collection	Detail
	Ghosh translation). Kashmir Shaivism texts: Shiva Sutras, Pratyabhijna Hridayam, and selected sections from Abhinavagupta's Tantraloka.
Bhakti Literature	The Nalayira Divya Prabandham in Tamil with transliteration and translation. The complete Tirumurai in Tamil with translation. The collected Abhangas of the major Warkari saints in Marathi with translation. The Ramcharitmanas in Awadhi with Hindi and English translation. The Kabir Dohas with translation. Mirabai's bhajans with translation. Selections from each regional tradition.
Scientific Texts	The Aryabhatiya in Sanskrit with translation. The Arthashastra in Sanskrit with English translation (R. Shamasastry). The Ashtadhyayi: the complete grammar in Sanskrit with an accessible introduction. Selected passages from the Charaka Samhita and Sushruta Samhita with translation. The Natyashastra in English translation.

1.13.2 - Platform Features for Text Engagement

- MULTI-LAYER READING MODE: Every text is available in multiple layers simultaneously: the Sanskrit/original text, the transliteration, the word-by-word analysis (for key passages), the translation, and the commentary. The reader can choose which layers to display - a beginner sees only the translation; an advanced learner sees Sanskrit and commentary alongside. The layers are implemented as toggleable overlays, not separate pages.
- THE COMMENTARY LIBRARY: For the most important texts (Bhagavad Gita, principal Upanishads, Yoga Sutras), the platform maintains a Commentary Library - a curated collection of 10-20 respected commentaries accessible with a single tap alongside the primary text. Every major commentary is searchable and cross-referenced. The learner can ask: how does Shankaracharya interpret this verse? How does Ramanuja read it differently? And see both commentaries side by side.
- AUDIO RECITATION: Every text in the Shruti tradition (Vedas, Upanishads, mantras, Gita) is accompanied by audio recitation from qualified Vedic chanters. The audio is synchronised with the text - as the chanter recites, the corresponding text is highlighted. Three recitation traditions are available for Vedic texts: Shaiva, Vaishnava, and Smarta traditions use different chanting styles for the same text.
- THE MANTRA LIBRARY: A dedicated section for the tradition's most important mantras: the Gayatri Mantra, the Maha Mrityunjaya Mantra, the Vishnu Sahasranama, the Lalita Sahasranama, the Hanuman Chalisa, the Shiva Panchakshara Stotram, the Durga Saptashati, the Purusha Sukta, the Sri Sukta, the Narayana Sukta - and hundreds more. Each mantra: Sanskrit text, transliteration, audio recitation, word-by-word meaning, and pronunciation guidance.
- CROSS-TEXT CONNECTIONS: The Library platform implements a knowledge graph connecting every text to every other text that references it. When reading a verse of

the Gita, links appear to: the Upanishadic passages that inspired it, the commentaries that interpret it, the Bhakti poetry that quotes it, and the modern studies that analyse it. The tradition's intellectual coherence is made visible through these connections.

- THE LEARNING PATH INTEGRATION: Every text in the Library is integrated with the Courses module. When a learner is enrolled in the Bhagavad Gita Level 2 course, their Library view is personalised - the relevant Gita chapters for the current week are highlighted, the week's assigned commentaries are pre-loaded, and the Study Circle questions are visible alongside the text.
- SEARCH AND DISCOVERY: Full-text search across the entire library in Sanskrit, Hindi, English, and Tamil. Search for a specific concept (like Nishkama Karma or Brahman) and find every occurrence across all texts, organised by text type and tradition. Search for a specific verse by its first words or by its theme. Personalised recommendations based on the learner's course history and reading patterns.

Feature	Detail
Languages at Launch	Sanskrit (all texts), Hindi (major texts), English (all major texts). Three regional languages in Phase 1 (Tamil for Nalayira Prabandham and Tirumurai; Marathi for Warkari literature; Bengali for Chaitanya tradition). Five additional regional languages in Phase 2 (Telugu, Kannada, Malayalam, Gujarati, Odia).
Text Formats	Readable (formatted for screen reading with comfortable typography), Study (formatted for serious study with verse numbers, commentary, and notes), Recitation (formatted for ritual or devotional recitation with pause markers and pronunciation guides), PDF Export (for offline use or printing).
Accessibility	Screen reader compatible. Font size adjustable. High contrast mode. All audio content has text transcripts. Devanagari rendered using a custom engine that correctly displays all conjunct consonants and vowel markers.
Academic Features	For advanced learners: manuscript variants noted for key passages, critical apparatus for the Mahabharata and Ramayana (based on BORI critical editions), Sanskrit etymological notes via the Amarakosha database, cross-references to the Nirukta tradition for Vedic words.